

Prague University of Economics and Business

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DEVELOPING BRAND IDENTITY BLUEPRINT FOR A CAFÉ BAR

BACHELOR THESIS

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Acknowledgement

I hereby declare that my bachelor's thesis on topic of „Developing brand identity blueprint for a café“ was worked out on my own and I have properly identified all the used literature and other sources and listed them in the attached list.

In Prague on 14th April 2023

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Abstract

This bachelor thesis deals with the creation of a corporate identity for the coffee place. The aim of this bachelor thesis is the creation of a functional brand design with a detailed description using the example of a particular specific company. The theoretical part describes what it takes to create a successful brand identity, how corporate design, culture and style are related and how this affects the product and the perception of the company. It also dedicates to outputting various types of logos, typography, and color palettes. At the beginning of the practical part, there is a thorough negotiation with the client to clearly define the goal and the expected results. Thereafter, the selected company, its current corporate identity and last but not least its competitors are described and analyzed in detail. It continues with the application of the knowledge from the theoretical part using the example of creating a completely unique brand identity. In the end, it displays the results in the form of a brand presentation.

Keywords

Branding, corporate identity, graphic design, logo.

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Introduction

In the environment of rapid development of the media world and information overload, it is the visual representation of a company - corporate identity, that plays a crucial role in the success of any business. Customers of coffee shops do not often even realize why they like being in the café so much and that it leaves a positive emotion in them. The reason for that is the overall atmosphere and style of the café which attracts them. A corporate style works as a system, which has to be complete in order to fulfill its purpose of attracting customers.

This bachelor thesis discusses the topic of corporate identity, and its main focus is on corporate design processing. The topic was chosen for several reasons. First of all, graphic and corporate identity design are one of my interests because my goal is to become a graphic designer. It fascinates me how many things do the concepts of corporate identity and design cover. I have been working in this area for some time and I wanted to create a comprehensive proposal for a corporate identity, including a larger description. As a client for the purpose of processing this work, I chose a small cafe that opened not so long time ago in the city of Zaporozhye where I come from. With this choice, I also wanted to help the café in the conditions of a bad economic situation, since not all young enterprises in Ukraine have the finance to create a corporate design for their business in the current situation.

The main objective of this bachelor thesis is to create a concept of a functional and unique corporate design with its possible application on an existing café. This draft should be developed based on both external and internal environment analysis of the company. The created visual representation of the company should be able to deliver the brand's philosophy and values to its customers, as well as distinguishing it from the competition.

This work is divided into theoretical and practical parts. In the theoretical part, I will focus on the gradually defining the concepts of a brand, branding and its process. Subsequently, I will explain the concept of corporate identity and describe all its mutually reinforcing components. Then I will define the corporate design and give a detailed presentation about all of its necessary elements: name, logo, font and colors. At the end of the theoretical part, the most commonly used derived elements of corporate design will be discussed.

The aim of the practical part is to create a visual identity design. At the beginning, I will define the assignment through communication and a brief with the client. After setting the goals, an analysis of the company, target group and also the competition will be done. After completing the analysis phase, I will start with the process of creating elements of corporate design and explain the possible application of these elements. The final step will be the creation of a presentation, which will include all the developed outputs.

Theoretical part

1 Brand as an effective tool for companies

In this chapter I would like to introduce the concept of a brand. What exactly covers this term, how and when it started to be widely used, tools to build a successful brand and its main functionality. Furthermore, what is the dissimilarity between brand identity, brand image and corporate identity.

1.1 Concept of a brand

‘The primary function of brands is to reduce our anxiety in making choices. The more we sense we know about a product, the less anxious we feel.’ (Nicholas Ind)

A lot of people are usually mistaken by thinking that brand is equal to name or logo of the company, but it's far from the reality.

Catharine Slade-Brooking defines it like *“far more than the name, logo, symbol or trademark that highlights its origin; it is imbued with a set of unique values that defines its character and works as an unwritten contract, promising to deliver satisfaction by providing consistent quality each time it is bought, used or experienced.”* (Catharine Slade-Brooking, 2016)

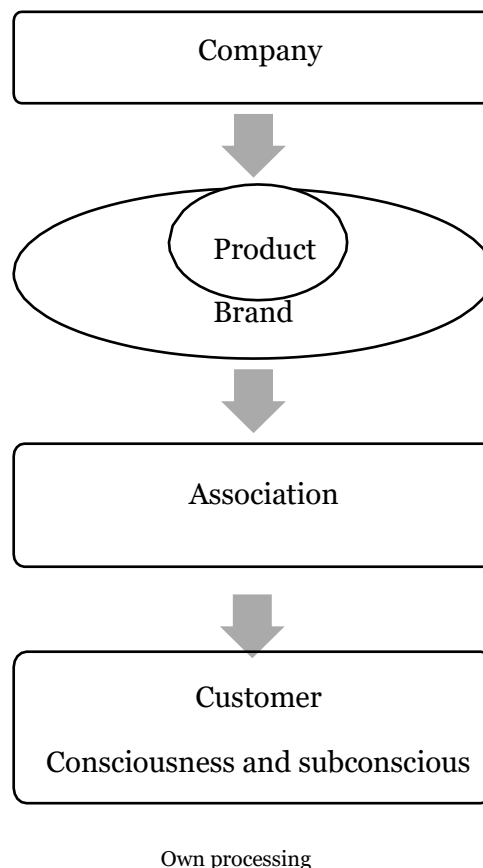
According to David Ogilvy brand is *„the intangible sum of a product's attributes: its name, packaging, and price, its history, its reputation, and the way it's advertised.“*

Consequently, a brand is a combination of the impression on consumers and the outcome of their experience of the product. Brand is what the consumer feels about the product or service: devotion, conviction and commitment.

Strictly speaking trademark is main component of prosperous product and brand is the “flexible personality” of the product. The clearest example is when under the influence of particular aspects, the brand and attitude towards it may be changed, while the product remains unchanged. But still there is no existence of brand without a product. The consumer's decision to purchase a particular product depends on the characteristics of the brand, and the impression of use is determined by the product itself.

A brand about the integrated perception and reputation of a product, service, or company in the minds of people. As was already mentioned, a brand contains such elements as the brand name, logo, design, slogan, packaging and much more. A well-built brand is memorable, distinctive, consistent and addressed to its clientry.

Figure 1: Brand



It's important to point out, that there are several types of brands which can be distinguished and are unique in its strategies, positioning and main attributes:

- Product brand – in this case brand represents one particular product with a set of ideas, opinions, emotions and value characteristics related to it. This is the oldest and most frequent type.
- Corporate brand – expression of the company's personality and reputation. It's oriented on media, investors, consumers, staff instead of the product or service.
- Personal brand – is a sort of an advancement of a media person, as well as the formation of a certain opinion about this person. This kind of branding is considerably younger than the other ones. It has become very popular with the evolution and rise of social networks and the emergence of bloggers - experts.
- Service brand - is focused on providing a specific type of service, such as hospitality, mobile operators, internet, or financial services. It is considered to be one of the most challenging type of branding, because services, unlike goods, can not be touched to understand their quality. (Investopidea, 2022)

In this subchapter I explained the concept of a brand and how it is perceived by people. I also highlighted different types of brands and what they represent.

1.2 Branding and its origins

Brand and branding are related concepts, but unlike the brand itself, branding is the way brand communicates to the world. This complex approach is used to build brand awareness, appeal to customers, and encourage their loyalty. Correctly positioning a brand requires a daily effort, overcoming the challenges and hard work to be the finest among competitors in the customers minds. (Wheeler, 2017)

Every brand wants to be perceived precisely as it wants to be regarded. Even if the owner does not brand his goods, the buyer will form an opinion about it. Branding is the process of producing accurate and right communication about what your brand is; it encompasses the methods and strategies that a company uses to create, sustain, and boost its brand image.

Because context is crucial, the identical outward characteristics, words, and graphics begin to be perceived differently over time. For example, if a brand claims to be innovative, it is important to maintain it with a certain form of communication. What was considered fresh and modern five years ago is seen in a completely different light today. Branding is not a process that can be done once and left on its own, but an ongoing and consistent monitoring of the brand's acceptance and conformity to the requirements of potential and existing customers.

However, branding can affect the brand in a negative way in a lot of cases. Few of them I want to display in a more detail:

- Inability to understand the meaning of branding – the owners should spend more time to really to get the concept, find an explanation or get an understanding that suits the brand the most to what it is doing because it is crucial to fully understand what branding is in order to apply it correctly on the business.
- Lack of consistency between communication channels - the brand should be presented equally through all the channels of your business: in print, on the website, in a blog and on social networks. Inconsistency contributes to the formation of a chaotic message to the public.
- Excessive focus on trends - both new and old brands can become a victim of fashion. Every year brings new hot trends in design. Of course, they can be used for inspiration or as a basis for changes, but literally copying them can cause harm. It is better to find a successful direction that will be held for a long time rather than following trends.

The origins of branding date back many centuries. Branding appeared the moment competing products came out. From 3000 BC to the 1750s, the primary task of branding was to differentiate a product or service from its competitors. To accomplish this, farmers and potters used their unique symbols and marks to identify their products, which could be

as simple as a seal on the bottom of a pot. Similarly, in ancient Egypt, burning a stigma on cattle was frequently used as a means of branding. (Wheeler, 2017)

Over time, branding has evolved to include more sophisticated techniques. Especially big change happened during the Industrial revolution, when there was a huge increase in mass production of goods. More products meant more choices for consumers, so it wasn't already enough just to distinguish product from another one. That's why all this lead to the creation of logos, slogans, and brand images. In 19th century first trademarks were registered. These included Coca-Cola (1886), Ford Motor Company (1903) and Bass Pale Ale (1876), Heinz & Noble Co (1869). (99designs, ©2020)

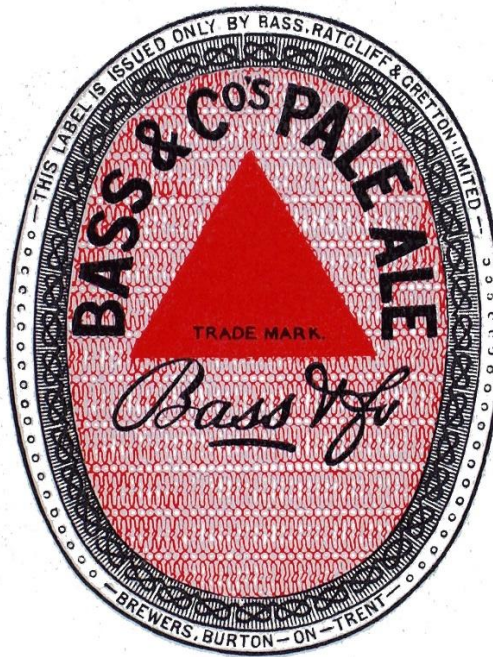
There have been also several Czech firms, that started their brand and manufacturing long time ago, among with the Baťa company founded in 1894 by three siblings, the handmade paper mill Velké Losiny which has been operating since 1596, and Mattoni, founded in 1873. These enterprises have achieved remarkable success and continue to prosper today. (Grizzlink, ©2018)

Figure 2: A Bar at the Foiles-Bergere



(Édouard Manet, 1882)

Figure 3: Logo of Bass Pale Ale in 1876



(Bass Pale Ale, 1876)

From the beginning of the twentieth century, branding was forming as a resource for the growth of companies and giving them value via marketing techniques for promoting a product or service, analyzing branding and its capabilities to impact customers. It was the era of the earliest advertising companies, when there was a significant need for professional branding. Radio and television commercials spread quickly.

In the 21st century branding has undergone compelling changes due to advancements in technology and reversing of the market trends. With the emergence of social media, TV and print advertisements ended up in second place. Firms can now effectively interact with customers through Instagram, Tiktok and Facebook and with that increase their brand's awareness. (99designs, ©2020)

One of the critical trends in branding in the 21st century has been a focus on personalization and empathy. Companies nowadays try to have a very intimate relationship with each and every single one of their consumers in order to do so they need to reach all age and gender groups with their branding and ads but that often backfires and causes drama and bad reputation instead of a positive outcome because its simply not possible to please everyone. Moving to personalization, companies can now leverage the abundance of data on consumer preferences and behaviors to customize their branding strategies to suit individual customers, thereby creating more engaging and personalized brand experiences. Brands became systems that are driven by consistency. (Medium, ©2021)

In this subchapter I explained the concept of branding and the way it works. I also examined and described the situations, when branding can affect a brand negatively.

1.3 Connection between brand identity and brand image

Brand identity is the way of how a brand wants to look in the eyes of the customers. Brand identity consists of both verbal and visual elements. It is created and supervised by the company to serve multiple purposes:

- Brand differentiation;
- Represent the brand's unique values, personality;
- Brand awareness;
- Build loyalty;
- Establish brand recognition.

According to Alina Wheeler (2017) „brand identity is tangible and appeals to the senses. You can see it, touch it, hold it, hear it, watch it move. Brand identity fuels recognition, amplifies differentiation, and makes big ideas and meaning accessible.“

Due to Keller brand identity is a “unique set of brand associations that represent what the brand stands and promises to customers” (Keller, 2008)

He claims that identity should reflect the brand’s values and personality to convey them effectively to the target audience. These actions play a significant role in building a positive brand image and establishing a strong brand reputation over time.

"Brand image is the set of beliefs, ideas, and impressions that a customer holds about a particular brand." (Kotler & Keller, 2012)

Kotler believed that brand image is formed by the sum of experiences that consumers have with the brand, while using its services or buying a product. Moreover, those experiences include people’s interactions with advertising, packaging, product quality, customer service, and other touchpoints. It is also important to point out that people’s perception of the brand always affects the brand’s culture.

Strong brand image can help to differentiate a brand from the competition, improve brand loyalty among prospective and current customers and positively influence brand equity. Brand image together with brand loyalty is playing a mediating role in the building of brand equity.

1.4 Corporate identity

In scientific literature there is no single definition of “corporate identity”, different writers or researchers interpret it in different ways.

Vysekalová a Mikeš (2009) defines it as an essential part of company’s strategy, that shows how the company presents itself through individual elements. They compare corporate identity to a person who has individual expressions of character and features. So primarily,

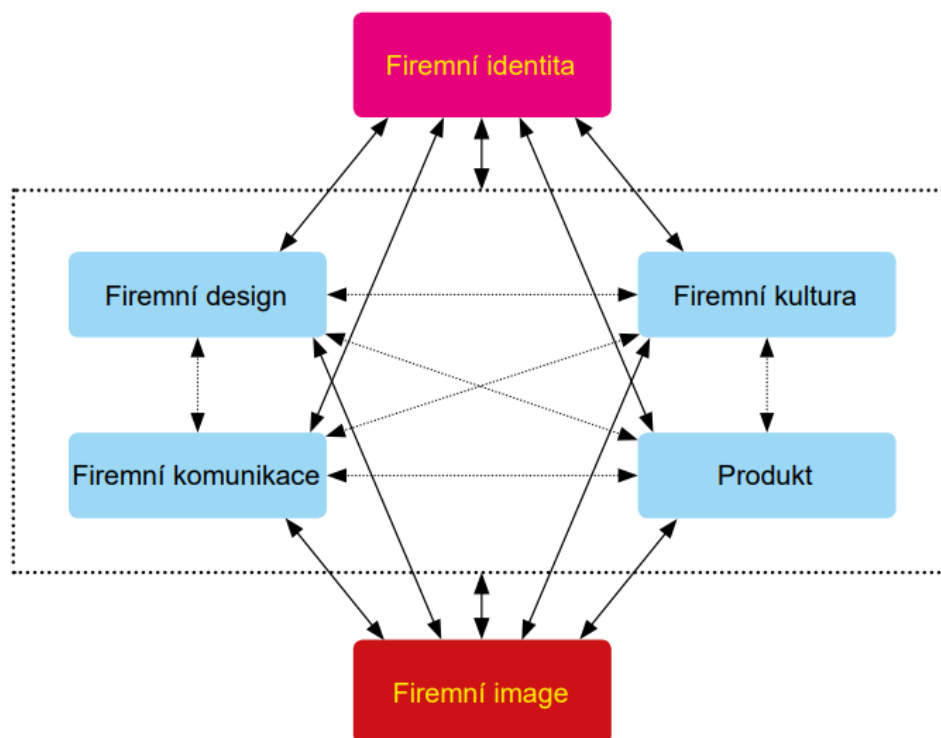
corporate identity displays the uniqueness of the character of the company and its core lies in the complexity and coherence image provided by the firm.

According to Horný corporate identity is meant to be a purposefully formed strategic concept of the inner structure, functioning and external presentation of a particular company. The main aim of this concept is to unequivocally identify and thus distinguish the corporation from its competitors. (Horný, 2016) This definition is quite similar to the previous one, since it is consequent that both authors see the same goal in the creation of corporate identity.

“Identity“ has become such a significant phenomenon in business management for the reason that the more the internal public of a particular organization internally identifies with it, the more pronounced its overall effectiveness is. This ultimately means that a unitedly behaving organisation gains more trust and continuous sympathy. The public is better able to identify with the organization that way. (Svoboda, 2002)

After all corporate identity is one of the branding elements that serves as a blueprint of the brand. It helps to reveal the essence and convey the brand values and significance of product to the buyer by using visual and verbal components: name, slogan, logo, color, font and brand character. Furthermore, corporate identity is the main factor that can affect the corporate image. There are four key branding elements, which together create the corporate identity: corporate design, corporate culture, corporate communication and the product. From the scheme that developed Vykydal (2001) we can see relations within the structure of corporate identity and mutual influence; also, it is noticeable, that these elements don't work separately, but as a whole.

Figure 4: Structure of corporate identity



(Jitka Vysekalová, Jiří Mikeš, Image a firemní identita, 2009)

Nevertheless, in some other resources it is possible to find differentiated compositions of corporate identity, where the product is replaced by another component such as corporate behaviour or corporate language: corporate design, corporate language, corporate culture, corporate behavior. (Wix, 2022) Horáková (2008) describes 5 components of corporate identity, there is no place for product, but at the same time the list has broadened out through corporate philosophy and corporate personality.

1.5 Branding steps

In this part of this bachelor thesis, I will focus on creating a detailed description of the steps of the branding process. I will explain its purpose, phases, what it consists of and why it is useful.

Alina Wheeler (2017) marks the following stages of the branding process:

1. Appraising

The primary aim is to correctly perceive and analyze the client's company, including its vision, values, product or services, corporate culture, strengths, weaknesses, and plans for the future. It is crucial to understand that without a company's foundation in the form of these core elements, visual identity cannot be designed and accurately tell the brand story. Before an interview, it's good to examine business background materials and the company's current position in the market. Here also comes identification and analysis of competitors. Moving through the process, it is good to understand how they present themselves in the meaning of visual identity, trends and specific industry points. Therefore, during this phase, the decisive factor is to ask the right questions. After that to achieve goals specified in the beginning of this stage it is all about conducting in-depth research of the company:

- Market research;
- Usability testing;
- Marketing audit;
- Competitive audit;
- Language audit;
- Audit readout.

2. Define a brand strategy

Second phase is a continuation of the first one, thus everything discovered earlier is processed into a comprehensive branding idea and identifying brand positioning. To develop a successful brand strategy, it's necessary to combine creative and rational thinking. Brand positioning is determined by employees, competitors, consumers, suppliers and the public. The shell provided by brand positioning should be felt at each contact of the brand with the consumer: in the brand name, visual image, advertising campaigns, communication through social networks.

That is why in this step we were dealing with the clear definition of what the brand is about, how a client desires to portray his brand, what is its value, who is the target audience and what is the best way to position yourself next to the competition. When undergoing the target audience research there must be a clear understanding of who are these people, what is their social status, values and preferences. After this it is a suitable time to provide a brief, that will ensure that the created identity aligns with the brand's vision and goals. It can be defined as an overview of what the brand genuinely is; client's preferences in corporate identity, attributes. The aim is to increase customer loyalty, build a strong community and distinguish from the competition.

Fundamentals on the way of creating a brand strategy:

- Brand positioning;
- Brand vision and values;
- Awareness goals;
- Brand personality;
- Brand name/rename;
- Brand voice;
- Brand brief.

(Crowdspring, 2022)

3. Designing brand identity

Design is a reiterative action that strives to merge meaning with style. Starting a design phase from the creation of a moodboard can significantly facilitate the following steps. Moodboard is the first representation and visualisation of the company's vision. The point is in gathering inspirational colours, fonts, patterns and shapes to understand the client better. (Medium, 2018) After doing so, design of brand identity continues with coming up with ideas, making sketches and afterwards development of several concepts, analyzing and comparing them to the creative brief. After carrying out these activities it advances with coordination with the client, choosing the final design and finalizing the creative approach with a presentation. Phase 3 includes following components:

- Logo design
- Color palettes
- Typography
- Testing the concept
- Presentation
- Delivery of the final work (Catharine Slade-Brooking, 2016)

4. Creation of touchpoints

After the design is created, it should be comprised in daily usage, contrarily it will come in vain. Brand identity needs to be dispersed through various marketing channels. It is important to establish a consistent and adaptable look and feel across all touchpoints, that

will effectively represent and communicate all values delineated in the brand strategy. (Wheeler, 2017)

Ways of applying the design:

- Start content strategy
- Social media pages
- Stationery
- Signage
- Product design
- Packaging
- Advertising
- Placemaking
- Uniforms

5. Resource management

Brand launch is considered to be the most foreseen event in the whole firm's history. Every brand launch calls for different launch strategies. Mostly launch is divided into two parts – internal and external. It's important not to overlook the most valuable listeners - the employees of the company, that's why starting with an internal launch will ensure that all company members are side by side with the brand's ideology, values and goals. Afterwards it will help to effectively communicate with customers, resulting in an overall positive impact on the brand.

Consequently, the external launch happens. Firstly, the appropriate model of launch should be selected, usually it is based on the market preferences and strategy. Then the focus of the company should be kept on its customers. The aim lays in prioritizing the target group of people and delivering the key message at a certain period of time.

Nevertheless, it is impossible to achieve the desired result without a completed brand book and brand guidelines. The fifth stage covers creating brand documentation:

- Brandbook – a motivational and inspirational book, which is often called “Brand Bible” created not only to help within the firm, but also to be contributive and helpful for the consumers. The major functions of the brandbook are to gather and systemize brand information, such as a description of brand values, philosophy of the brand and positioning strategy in one place. A well-formed and versatile brandbook motivates the team to be more engaged with the brand and its values. After getting familiar with it, a comprehensive vision of the brand is gained.
- Brand design guidelines – a collection of standards and regulations that describe the design development process for the brand in detail. It includes the making of a logo, color palette, font selection, design elements and voice. (Looka, 2022)

In this chapter, I went through the concept of a brand and branding as a process with all its steps accordingly, its history. After going through the whole process of branding it became clear that it is a complex approach which includes a full analysis of the company, conduction

of the brand strategy, brand identity design, preparation of the consistent look on the touchpoints and finally a creation of a brand documentation. Moreover, I also put a big emphasis on understanding the relationship between brand identity and brand image and what role it plays in corporate identity in all of it.

2 Components of a recognizable corporate identity

Visual representation through marketing materials like logos, ads, and social media presence comes to mind when discussing corporate identity. However, the distinctive corporate identity starts within the organization and radiates outward. In this chapter I would like to present the role of each corporate's identity elements in a more thorough and delineated way, explaining their differentiation and role in building a corporate identity.

2.1 Corporate design

Corporate design is the visual representation of the company's reflection, encompassing its values, attitudes, accomplishments, and competencies. Companies do not develop the corporate design for internal use within the firm but for the public. Corporate design at the hand of its elements, conveys the desired image of a company to its intended audience, which includes customers, partners, and employees. All this establishes identification potential concerning the company's competence, attitude, and performance promise both internally and externally.

Created design should emanate the identity and, by that, create and maintain the company's image. The outcome will be efficacious only in the case of long-term focused "face" influence. (Svobodá, 2002)

The term corporate design is often substituted for "uniform visual style." Nevertheless, for example, Horný never replaced the two of these, quite the opposite actually. He always uses it as an individual expression with a different meaning. (Horný, 2016)

Vysekalová and Mikeš delimit corporate design as a set of visual constants used inside and outside the company's communication. The graphic appearance of the visual style components is ingrained in the graphic manual, which is, above all, only the first step towards creating a unified corporate identity. Primarily it deals with the usage of different graphic elements that apply to the corporate style. This type of manual sets out how to manipulate individual components and use them correctly in the company's printed and electronic visual presentations. (Vysekálová a Mikeš, 2009)

The corporate design includes the following elements of visual rendering:

- Name of the company;
- Logo;
- Symbol;
- Typography;
- Color pallet;

- Promotional products and prints;
- Signage;
- Packaging design;
- Uniforms;
- Marketplaces and advertisements.

The application of these described methods is in the practical part. It is the fundamental topic of this thesis. In the next sub-chapter, we will be discussing the individual elements in more detail.

2.2 Corporate communication

Corporate communication is a peculiar environment that helps employees be sufficiently informed, communicate inside and outside of the company to influence the changes occurring in the company and refine and maintain the firm's image.

In one of his works, Balmer also notes that corporate communication serves as a bridge between an organization's corporate identity and awareness appropriated to the company's stakeholders. (Balmer, 2017)

The management of an organization mainly drives corporate communication. This communication focuses on vital public segments, such as shareholders, creditors, suppliers, government agencies, and others. Horný highlights the following corporate communications goals:

- Raising the public's awareness about business planning and strategy;
- Presenting an accurate image of the organization to the target audience;
- Identifying relevant areas of interest;
- Informing the key audience about price adjustments of the product or product itself. (Horný, 2016)

Corporate communication encompasses a wide range of activities, including:

- Public relations – procuring communication and relation with the public;
- Corporate advertising - paid messages in the form of advertisements, communication of company attitudes, opinions, and positions on various issues of public interest expressed through different media channels. It is intended to affect consumers' perceptions and attitudes toward the company;
- Human relations – relationships and communication between people inside and outside the company in the labor market it is an essential factor for the company to be successful and to keep employees motivated;
- Investor relations – a kind of public relations that provides precise targeted communication to ensure effective management and control of information flow between stakeholders, investors, and the company.
- Government relations – the main focus is set on communication between the company and major figures in the government, the primary purpose of which is to

build long-term mutually beneficial relations of the company with government authorities.

- Employee relations – the practice of improving and making positive relationships between employees and the company, promoting mutual understanding. Moreover, it encourages employees to actively participate in achieving the company's goals and objectives. (Vysekalová a Mikeš, 2009)

2.3 Corporate culture

Corporate culture is crucial for improving organizations' key capabilities and functioning.

In a real sense, corporate culture can be considered a company's "personality." Every organization regardless of its size has a culture that influences how people behave, in a variety of areas, such as the treatment of customers, standards of performance, and innovation. (Framholtz and Randle, 2011)

Corporate culture is a collection of many immaterial and material phenomena, so we can observe the lack of a common understanding of the corporate culture concept. Horný represents two different perceptions of the corporate culture. In the first case, corporate culture is presented as a tool in the management process of a firm, which is strictly defined and outlined with regulations and rules. It is based on financial standards and norms. In the second case, corporate culture is perceived as a model of principles, values, and relationships. Exactly these components are considered to be the company's primary aim and, in contradistinction to the first case, matters not strictly formal phrasings but actual results and functioning. These cases of corporate culture do not directly occur in practice, but the corporate culture of a particular firm is usually more similar to the first model or the second. (Horný, 2016)

Components of corporate culture:

- Symbols – everything begins from slang through the manner of dressing to marked parking spaces, something that is known only for employees of the particular company;
- Heroes – can be real ones or invented;
- Rituals – formal or informal time spending and activities, for example, recognizing birthdays, conducting regular special events, ringing a bell when something important was done;
- Values – the most profound dimension of culture, general understanding, and distinguishing between good and bad. (Vysekalová a Mikeš, 2009)

All companies are different in the effectiveness of defining, communicating, and managing the company's corporate culture. Strong corporate culture is one where an explicit culture is communicated and reinforced consistently, and all employees behave according to it. It is impossible to build a robust corporate culture only by having a statement of values, the values should be communicated not only in words but also in actions. A weak corporate

culture is one, when employees have difficulties with defining and understanding the values and culture itself. (Framholtz and Randle, 2011)

Essential attributes of a strong corporate culture:

- Concision – employees of the company clearly understand what behavior is appropriate and which actions are desirable;
- Extension – it is important for employees not only to know values, fitting behavior, and defined values but to daily use it in basic and extraordinary situations at work;
- Anchorage – in order for a company to have a strong corporate culture, all components should be experienced;

2.4 Product

The product can be a material thing, food, service, a new car, trips to South America, and even things like licenses and patents. The product is a crucial element while forming the corporate identity as it satisfies the target audience's needs and contributes to the essence of the company's existence. It's obvious that best designs created according to the latest trends and communication will not help to build proper corporate identity, until there is a competitive quality product.

Important emotional characteristics of the product during the creation of corporate identity include:

- Product as a way or symbol of self-expression, self-confidence or peace;
- An overall experience by using a product or service;
- The aesthetic look of the product satisfies individual needs of the customer;
- Raise of prestige with the help of the product. (Vysekálová a Mikeš, 2009)

People almost always view a product as a way to fulfill their needs or wishes, so it is not a surprise that their decision to purchase is based on the information about the product, its look, how they feel about it, and if this information has the ability to satisfy their needs or desires. These emotions form the base of the means-end theory which explains how consumers make their purchase decisions. However, the decision-making process is also impacted by the other components of corporate identity, including corporate communication, design, and culture.

Marketing mix can be defined as a set of tactical marketing tools with the help of which the company's marketing strategy is implemented. All the forming elements of the marketing mix can be easily controlled, therefore, by the correct manipulation of them, the company can maintain a stable position on the market and sensitively respond to the any changes. (Krejta solutions, ©2023)

Marketing mix in the meaning of product defines the following product levels:

- Basic utility effect and reaching the promised product
- The second layer is created by quality, brand, packaging, design and style

- Extended product – not about every product, but it belongs to more technically demanding products
- This fourth layer is created by the image of the product and the customer's perception of it. (Lumenlearning, 2017)

I dedicated the second chapter to the complete description of all the corporate identity components. I explained what role does corporate design play among the other elements and mentioned what it consists of. I then continued with the description of corporate communications explaining why this element is also crucial and which activities does it include. Moreover, I talked about the corporate culture and explained what is needed to build a strong one and how does the final product fit in all of this.

3 Essentials of corporate design

In this chapter I will write a detailed description of corporate design elements and its attributes. I also dedicated a part for the explanation of how to create a good design.

3.1 Naming

Naming as a process is among the most critical parts in creating a corporate identity and brand itself. It is a constituent of brand strategy, serving as a chance for the company to set apart from its rivals, establish a connection with the intended audience, and initiate the first stages of brand awareness. To create a unique brand name, it is important to start with a solid strategy that involves evaluation of the company, customers, and competitors.

The name is a simple set of letters and words. The real meaning of naming is only revealed within the context of the entire brand. Therefore, creating a brand name requires a combination of marketing, linguistics, and law. Marketing helps to discover and analyze audience requests, competitive offers and market trends. Linguistics is needed to develop a name and analyze it at the level of semantics, including translation into other languages. Jurisprudence helps to assess the feasibility of registering the name legally and ensuring its protection in the future.

3.1.1 Principles of naming

Factors, that should be taken into consideration, while creating a name for a brand:

1. Make a brand name memorable

A brand name serves the function of company's identification as a business card, whether online or offline. Catchy brand name enables the vital link between the customer and the business itself, its offerings, making it easy for people to find a brand, order products or services, and share information about their experience with their friends or relatives. Names that are oddly spelt, buzz words, foreign-sounding, too elementary or confusing, can be challenging to remember and may also be difficult to search for online.

2. Distinctiveness

A strong brand name should be unique and special enough that it allows to search and order online without errors, instant recognition on shop's shelves, and easy recall by customers when it is compared with competitors during the decision-making process. That's why it is highly important within the same industry. Moreover, domain availability for the brand name should be checked and trademark registration provided.

3. Sound of the name

For sure, a brand's name has to cover core values, but in reality, the emphasis is often more on the sound of the name rather than its meaning. A brand's name is the first audio-visual association, including shape and sound, that a consumer has with the brand. A good brand name should be memorable by being quite short, with a maximum of two syllables, have a compelling story behind the name and express only one clear meaning.

4. Name without boxes

It is better to avoid restrictive names, that will box the company into particular niche and afterwards it will be challenging to expand the business. (Personadesign, 2022)

3.1.2 Types of names

1. Descriptive brand names

The main sense and key of brand activities lies in the descriptive brand name. From it a customer can instantly figure out what product or service the brand is offering. This kind of name is effective for clear brand positioning. Examples can be Novinky.cz, The Body Shop, Czech National Bank. On the other hand, there is also drawback of descriptive brand name – weakening of the business in the case of growth and desire to be diversified.

2. Invented brand names

If there is no suitable word for the brand it is always possible to make one up, so considerably often invented names are a fresh breath of air. Invented brand names are unique as they are not limited with existing words. But the truth is it's challenging to produce a name that sounds real and has resemblance of meaning. Most invented brand names are derived from common root origins or it is a combination of two words or intentional misspellings of an existing word. When selecting an invented brand name, it is essential to make an effective marketing communication strategy, that will help customers to understand the core business and what stands under the brand name. Examples of invented brand names are Google, Accenture, Adidas, Sony.

3. Evocative brand names

Evocative brand names are built in a way to leave customers with an information gap, which they have to fill themselves. This kind of brand name has a unique and original nature, that is able to make product diversification. However, it's not convenient for small businesses, when the company leaves customers with insufficient information to understand the company's offer. Evocative brand names are easier to trademark, but it is very hard to come by a free one, which is not already trademarked. Examples of these names are Nike, Uber, Apple.

4. Lexical brand names

Lexical brand names are formed with clever and witty language. This results in unique and memorable company name. This type of name mostly relies on wordplays, such as puns, alliteration, onomatopoeia, intentional misspellings, compound words, and foreign words. This type of naming is trendy and effective in snack food, pet supplies, and restaurant

industries, where brands want to evoke a sense of playfulness and lightheartedness. Examples of the lexical naming are Whiskas, Donuter, Hubba Bubba.

5. Acronymic Brand Names

Conglomerates and major corporations use acronyms as names in order to help themselves to diversify their offers and provide a variety of offers to different markets. However, there is a disadvantage of acronymic naming, as they could be unemotional and lack the personality that is desired in brand identity, so much attention should be given while designing the marketing communication strategy with an acronymic brand name. Well-known examples of this naming are IBM, KPMG, and BMW.

6. Geographical brand names

This type of naming is used especially when the business has a solid connection to a particular geographic place and is deeply rooted in the birthplace. Moreover, it is a good option if the company targets a certain audience from a specific region. One potential problem could be that the business may experience growth beyond the geographic area, which was initially targeted and included in the brand name. That could lead to expectations that no longer align with the actual reach of the company. Examples of geographic brand names are Bohemia Sekt, Reflex, and Czech Airlines.

7. Founder brand names

Brands can be named for the people who started them or significantly impacted the firm's growth. It can be both the name or surname of the person, or some abbreviation, that comes from the surname. Although this type of naming is not highly popular nowadays, it is still easy to find many family names on products in different shops. Name-based brands include Ford, Baťa, Calvin Klein, and Ben & Jerry's. (Ignytebrands, 2015)

3.2 Logo

A logo is vital to corporate identity, without it identity loses meaning and functionality.

A logo is a visual identifier to communicate with an individual or company that requires identification. It can consist of words, images, or a combination of both and attempts to portray or reflect the represented person or institution. For individuals, the logo may be derived from their name. Logos can be abstract or use language to convey meaning. A good logo should accurately depict a company's values and what they do. Logo design is the process of creating the matching visual brand mark for an enterprise and typically involves a symbol or brandmark, a logotype, and a tagline. (Gareth Hardy, 2011)

Whether a logo represents the right image of the company belongs to one of the main criteria for assessing the suitability of the logo. A logo can either improve or worsen a company's image and rating. (Horský, 2016)

3.2.1 Attributes of a great logo

- Simplicity

A logo must be simple because it will be easier for customers or the targeted audience to remember it. By the simplicity of the logo, it is possible to let consumers understand the brand. Hence, people recognize it faster, and it will help build long-term relationships between the company and the customer.

- Memorability

The memorableness of a logo is really connected to its simplicity. Feeting, readable fonts, and minimalistic shapes can contribute to it. Otherwise, colorful options can also be successful, but it is crucial not to overdo it.

- Timelessness

It certainly depends for which company the logo is created, but a good logo should stay universal and fresh even after several years or decades and not be based on trends. Keep it simple and nothing should go wrong.

- Scalability

The logo needs to work perfectly in a different context – be consistent, look good, and be responsive, so it is easy to scale up or down a logo without losing quality and work across different mediums.

- Appropriateness

The logo should be appropriate for the company. The style of the logo has to be closely connected to the company's personality and the values it esteems. It must aswell be relevant to the target group of people. The cultural context also plays an essential role in this process because some elements or colors are perceived positively in the Czech Republic or Europe, but they can have a very different meaning or even be rude in other countries.

3.2.2 Variety of different logo types

Generally, logos can be divided into two main categories: image or icon-based and name-based logos. However, then there are a few types of each category and a combination of both. (Horný, 2016) As mentioned, a logo's purpose is to create the appropriate associations and convey the essence of the brand. Ultimately, based on performed research, it depends on the designer's and client's decision on which visual elements are suitable and what type of communication style is appropriate for this industry.

Thus, logos can be categorized into the following groups:

1. Wordmark

Wordmark – a purely text-based logo of the brand, without any icons or images. Wordmark is a good choice for businesses with catchy and memorable names. This type of logo can help speed up enlightening customers with a new brand that has recently entered the market. The primary emphasis is placed on logo font and colors to reflect the company's vibe.

Figure 5: Wordmark logo



own processing according to (Behance)

2. Lettermark

Lettermark or monogram is also a typography-based logo, usually made by the initials of a business or individual. If the business name is lengthy and hard to read on small objects, choosing a lettermark can be a good option. Moreover, monogram logos are often linked with the wealthy, so it is a fitting choice to appeal to a fancier audience through a lettermark logo.

Figure 6: Lettermark logo



3. Letterform

Letterform – is somewhat similar to lettermark, they are often confused with each other, but they are not alike. Letterform is usually created from a single or a number of letters. Letterforms can be bold and loud but, at the same time, iconic and powerful because of their simple structure.

Figure 7: Letterform logo



(Yaroslav Iakovlev, ©2023)

4. Pictorial logo mark

Pictorial mark – is a drawn logo with a graphic symbol or icon. Pictorial mark is easy to remember and it establishes an instant connection with the audience by using familiar and recognizable images that do not need to be explained. The most challenging part of creating this logo, particularly for a new brand, is to find a suitable image to represent the brand.

Figure 8: Pictorial logo mark

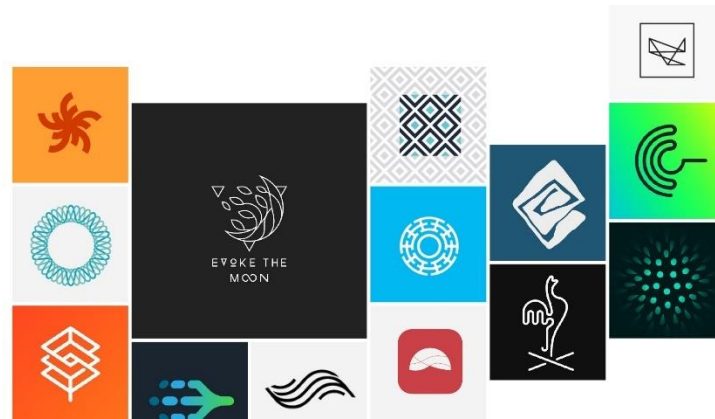


(Jessica Jones Design, 2017)

5. Abstract logo mark

Abstract mark – is way more metaphorical than a pictorial mark. This type of logo includes creating something unique that can tell a story but is less recognizable which can result in a worse connection with the people and poor readability.

Figure 9: Abstract logo mark



(workerbee, 99designs, 2018)

6. Mascot

Mascot – is such a family-friendly logo, where the character represents the business. The mascot logo convey the impression of warmth to the audience, which leads to a highly memorable brand. The cartoon-style of characters evokes humor and reminds of childhood. Consequently, mascot logos have the potential to build stronger connections with people, maintain a friendly image of the brand and cultivate brand loyalty.

Figure 10: Mascot logo



(Taylorbrands, @2022)

7. Emblem logo mark

Emblem mark – is a type of logo design that uses a font inside an icon or symbol that resembles an emblem, a distinctive sign, or a coat of arms. This type of logo evokes associations like aristocracy, tradition, style, and sophistication. As a rule, it is complex, multi-layered compositions that look quite concise and severe, and at the same time they impress with their power. Such effect is achieved by using a variety of details, elements and objects that increase the importance of logos-emblems.

Figure 11: Emblem logo mark



(The Logo Creative, © 2023)

8. Combination mark

Combination mark – is a logo comprehended of a wordmark or lettermark and pictorial mark, mascot or abstract mark. A combination mark is a widely used logo type among brands from various industries because of its versatility. With this type of logo, it is possible to make several versions of the brand's logo and use it to achieve different goals while maintaining a consistent visual style. (Gareth Hardy, 2011)

Figure 12: Combination mark logo



(Jessica Jones Design, 2017)

3.3 Colors

Color is part of the brand image. There is no secret that emotions play a crucial role in people's decision-making process, so the brand always aims to establish a deep emotional connection with its customers. However, it is not possible to convey the entire company's story through a logo or showcase. Nevertheless, corporate colors can be a shortcut to connecting with customers on an emotional level. All in all, colors help to solve several marketing tasks, such as:

- identifying the brand because the brand must be clearly associated with one or few colors;
- identifying the product category in which the company operates;
- differentiate the brand from competitors;
- strengthening the emotional image of the brand.

While specific colors are applied to create a consistent brand identity, others can explain the brand architecture. (Wheeler, 2016)

To the definition of colors in the corporate identity, Horný added that corporate colors can either be a separate element of corporate identity or be defined and used within the logo. (Horný, 2016)

Before discovering the main color and its combination, it is important to mention Itten's color wheel, that represents different colors of the visible spectrum. These colors are placed by sectors in an order close to their location in the color spectrum. The circle helps to select the optimal color combinations for a balanced and outstanding corporate design.

Figure 13: The extended color wheel by Itten



(Edouard Fouche, 2017)

In total, Itten's wheel includes 12 different colors, which are divided into three categories of colors:

- Primary colors: yellow, red, and blue. They are located in the center of the circle and are considered to be the main ones. By mixing them, it is possible to get any shade available to the human eye.
- Secondary colors: a hexagon of secondary colors is outlined around the main triangle, including green, orange, and purple. These colors are obtained by mixing primary colors.
- Tertiary colors: there are six of them, including blue-green, yellow-green, red-orange, red-purple, blue-purple, and yellow-orange. They are reached by mixing the primary and secondary colors that are side by side in the circle. (Skillbox, 2022)

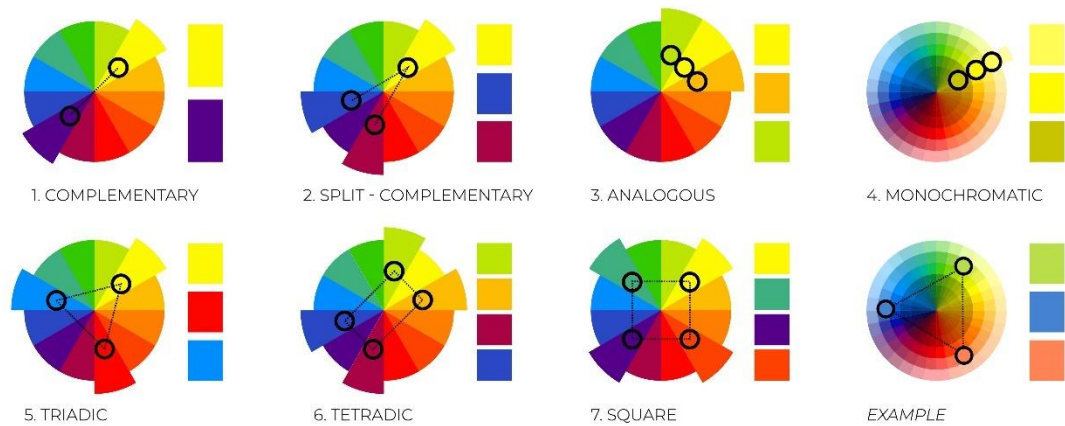
In the process of choosing colors and color palette for the corporate identity, it is crucial to start with the selection of primary color that embodies the business in the best way, based on the meanings of colors. Then, to continue with choosing the secondary colors, usually it is from two to four colors and we finalize it with picking neutral colors, mostly background colors. Additional colors are chosen to complement the main color, they can be used in combination with the primary one or independently. There are various options available, offered by different color schemes when selecting secondary colors. This is the reason why this wheel is so important, all digital color generators work based on these principles.

Types of color harmonies:

- 1) Monochromatic color scheme – this color scheme compounds different shades of the main color. It can help accentuate the brand color's meaning, which is perfect for minimalistic brands. However, it is pretty complicated to avoid visual monotony.
- 2) Analogous color scheme – in this color scheme, colors are located each other on the wheel. There is a subtle contrast and it usually presents analogous emotional connotations. Choosing color palette based on an analogous color scheme is a safe choice, but it will not be easy to stand out from the competition.
- 3) Complementary color scheme – is the most percussive type of a color scheme, a combination of colors located on opposite sides of the circle. It is a good fit for the arrangement of accents. Complementary colors are excellent for creating stimulating and dynamic visuals.
- 4) Split-complementary color scheme – is a scheme that uses one base and two secondary colors. Three colors give an extensive range of combinations, they are quite expressive, almost like the contrast in complementary color scheme, but slightly softened. However, the use of split-complementary color scheme may result in less vibrant and attention-grabbing visuals because of the range of colors.
- 5) Triadic color scheme – looks like an equilateral triangle, which is made up of any three colors that are at the same distance from each other and also expressively saturated. In the case of applying this scheme, it is desirable to make one of the colors of the triad as a solo, the second – basic, and the third as an accent.
- 6) Double complementary color scheme – it is also called tetradic, believed to be the most plentiful of all color schemas, as there are two pairs that complement each other. This color scheme is very intense, and it demands a highly emotional path to harmonize relations between the colors. It is crucial to select a dominant color or to overwhelm other colors.

Figure 14: Color harmonies

COLOR HARMONIES



(csiling, Adobe Stock, ©2023)

Historically colors have been used to convey symbolic meanings. For instance, countries have incorporated specific colors in their flags and military uniforms. Furthermore, certain colors have evolved over time to represent specific moods or ideas, making it a useful visual tool. As a result, the customer's choice can be directly impacted and contingent on brand's colors. Gareth Hardy, in his book represents the psychology of color and goes through associations and emotions that come from different colors:

Figure 15: Emotion of colors

power death misery elegance sophistication	optimism warmth excitement enthusiasm pride	serenity trust stability wisdom freedom
purity innocence simplicity peace impersonal	happines enlightenment joy disappointment warning	royalty luxury mysterious arrogant ambition
passion romance energy danger anger	growth health reassuring balance envy	comfort earth isolation strength resilience

3.4 Typography

Typography is all about organizing letters and text in a way that looks good, is readable and visually appealing to the reader. It involves font style, appearance, and structure, which aims to raise particular emotions and provide specific messages.

Typography plays a crucial role in the design, but often it is not thought out in detail. Feeble typography can have a negative impact on the overall image and deter potential customers. The corporate font is the last, but not the least element of corporate design. This process includes not only choosing a font but also arranging all typographic elements, such as visual arrangement, a contrast of the color, spacing between letters, and font size. Each of them affects the corporate design on both macro and micro level. (Gareth Hardy, 2011)

Simply, typography refers to the style and way of presenting the text. While creating a brand and corporate identity, it is important to use a consistent font type for a specific purpose. All in all typography definitely helps to create a unique context and maintain the brand's distinctive personality.

There is a need of understanding of the following concepts to successfully choose a font and ensure that it blends well with all inclusive elements which are the essential parts of the process:

- 1) Font – is the physical specific elements that contain a typeface to apply typeface. It is a more explicit way of delineating what kind of text is used. It can be Arial Regular, Merriweather Bold, or Helvetica Light – all these are fonts of different typefaces.
- 2) Font family – is a group of cuts derived from one typeface, and these fonts are related. So, compilation of more than one particular font style is font family. The full family includes all font variants: regular font and distinguished versions of the regular one, such as upright versions of fonts, italics, different strokes, and character widths.
- 3) Typeface – is a combination of distinct design attributes that define a specific style of lettering. Among these attributes can be the presence or absence of serifs, the spacing, height and width of the letters and other elements. Typefaces are Arial, Gotham, Merriweather. (Editorx, 2021)

There are several main types of typefaces:

- 1) Serif – here belongs all typefaces with serifs that are additional strokes at the tips of letters. Serifs come in a variety of shapes – rounded, triangular, teardrop-shaped, and rectangular. This is one of the most common kinds of typefaces, more familiar to readers, which is successfully used both in books and on the Internet. Such fonts have sophisticated feel, and they are easy to read, because of the emphasis put on the ends of strokes.
- 2) Sans serif – are fonts that do not include any serifs or other elements. Through time, they have become even more used than serif typeface fonts. The most common

- techniques are circular letters, high contrast, maximum simplicity, and fineness of lines. Sans serif fonts are modern and universal, they can be a good fit in process diagrams, animated advertisements on social media, or training manuals. The reason they are so widely used is the clean look and crisp lines. (Designmodo, 2023)
- 3) Slab serif – this one can be counted as a part of serif typeface. It is a pronounced type of antiquity. Its peculiarity lies in the low contrast between the connecting and main lines of symbols and rectangular serifs, similar to bars. Slab serif typeface fonts are good at being prominent and attracting people's attraction. Moreover, this typeface has more possibilities regarding the weight and width of symbols. Perfect fit for headers of documents and presentation earlier was widely used in logo creation.
 - 4) Script – this typeface is all about handwritten fonts, formal and casual styles. Scripts are designed to give the impression of flourish and artistry of hand lettering and calligraphy. Mostly they are decorative in nature, so they cannot be accepted for the main text. In general, scripts look interesting and authentic, because such fonts can embody emotions and different styles. But all that depends on what kind of script is used – it can be childish, light, or romantic. (Visme, 2022)
 - 5) Monospaced – are fonts where the width for the characters and letters remains the same. Monospaced fonts are pretty different from proportional fonts as, in proportional fonts, all the letters take minimal space horizontally. From the beginning, monospaced fonts were invented to suit the needs of typewriters. However, monospaced fonts are hard to read in large blocks. Conversely, it is convenient for programming because code is read not like books but by blocks. This typeface doesn't offer such flexibility and range of expression as other typefaces.
 - 6) Display – also called decorative, fonts created with a personality. This typeface includes modified versions of other known typefaces, like serif, sans serif, slab serif, and others. Display typefaces have more eccentric and diverse looks in comparison to usual typefaces. Their distinctive forms attract people and create a mood, they can be used in formal and informal designs. (Hubspot, 2022)

Figure 16: Typefaces



(own processing)

Therefore, while choosing fonts for corporate design, it is crucial to follow the next criteria (Horný, 2016):

- Clarity – font should be clear and not disappear on the background, it needs to be related to the overall concept of corporate identity – it has to be harmoniously combined with the logo and corporate colors.

- Right combination of the font types – the rule is to limit the number of used fonts in the corporate design and documents to the minimum. The suitable number of fonts in the corporate design cannot exceed three fonts, otherwise, fonts can distract and confuse the customer.
- Easy readability – it's considerably the same as in a logo creation. Fonts convey the brand message to the customers, including headlines fonts, main text fonts and others. Readers will not spend much time trying to understand what is encrypted in a particular word, so it should be easy to read. (Psychologiefontu, © 2019)
- Equilibrium – it is not sufficient for the font to just be easily readable, because the arrangement of the text can also change the whole situation.
- Practical applicability – it should be possible to utilize the font for corporate design on corporate presentations, advertisements banners, corporate clothing and others.
- Accessibility of font – in most cases, it relates to custom fonts which aren't preinstalled and have to be accessible for everyone to use in everyday life.

All in all, choosing the right fonts for corporate design is relatively an individual issue, which depends on loads of already specified factors, including personal feeling, connection with the logotype and overall design idea and comprehensive designer experience.

3.5 Graphic standards manual

It is certain that a well positioned brand is accompanied by a graphic standards manual that includes all elements of consistent corporate style and describes the rules for its use. The development of graphic manual is intended for both small and large companies, but the conditions for its creation are different. Usually, the manual for corporations is much more extensive and requires substantial funds due to the number of needed manual copies and the complexity of the solution's implementation. In the case of a company which has no graphic manual, the employees create their own standards, afterward, the customers do not receive a consistent message about the company, and in the end, the brand's image can be damaged.

It follows that the graphic standards manual must be present in the company and unequivocally bind to ensure compliance with the principles of corporate design by all employees.

The manual generally can exist in paper and electronic forms. Nowadays, with the huge progress of the digital world, the electronic form is far more spread, and it also becomes mandatory. In addition to the manual, a set of templates for the required adjustment of printed materials should be supplied to achieve a uniform visual identity.

Furthermore, according to Horný, there are several types of manuals in compliance with its contents as a minimum, standard, and extended versions. Primarily it depends on the purpose of creating the manual, the size of the firm and the amount of the budget. The minimum version is a basis for the visual identification of small companies or start-ups. The standard version is set for bigger enterprises, and in contradistinction to the minimum version of the manual, the standard version already defines all crucial elements such as

introduction, logo, color palette, prints, used typography, and vehicle markings. And the expanded version, which today is used by the majority of firms, even regardless of the size of the firm, as they heed to observance to their corporate design. Besides, this version includes the application of logos, corporate clothing, internal publications, and packaging designs. (Horný, 2016)

However, even with the extensive graphic manual for the firm, it is essential to understand that the mere existence of it is not enough, and it is necessary for these principles to be included in everyday life of the enterprise.

In this chapter I gave a detailed description of the corporate design. I explained what are the requirements for a good name and logo and different types of names and logos. I also explained color as an element of design, from where do color harmonies originate and what are the associations of different colors. Also, the concepts of typography, typefaces and fonts were clarified. This chapter ended with a description of a graphic manual and an explanation of its role in corporate design.

4 Secondary corporate design elements

Secondary elements certainly are not less important than main corporate design elements. Derived items of corporate design ensue from the basic corporate style's constants. The list of these elements varies depending on the specific company and its requirement. However, it is uncommon for all the corporate design derived items to be used. The reason is that if the proposed project is sufficiently timeless and creative, it does not have to include as many of these derived elements as possible. These items can include Business cards, small promotional items, letterheads, promotional textiles, brochures, advertisement banners, and packaging design come under these derived items. They are designed to be consistent with the entrenched corporate identity and reinforce brand recognition.

4.1 Mercantile prints

Mercantile or corporate prints include all documents that are widely used in the company's everyday communication, both external and internal. They are a particular way of presentation and promotion in communication with other parties which displays unity and self-identification.

4.1.1 Business card

This derived element might be the frequently used and most known. It is a small-sized (like a credit card) particle containing basic information about a person or company, such as its name, address, website url, social media. There are two types of business cards a company one and a personal one. The standard size for both is 90 mm x 55 mm, considering setting the trim line at 3 mm from the edge and then setting the safety line at 3 mm from the trim line, so 6 mm in total. Nevertheless, sometimes, it can be 4 mm instead of 6 mm in total. Those factors depend on the size and the printer. (99designs, 2018)

Most business cards are made in a minimalistic style, so overloading them with ornamental headlines and massive graphic elements is inappropriate. (Horný, 2016) It is also crucial to remember that a business card has two sides and design should be balanced on the both of them. Often one side is dedicated entirely to the logo and brand name, while the other displays the company's contact information. However, it's also acceptable to have the logo on both sides, so the range of possibilities for logo placement is wide.

When discussing typesetting, one popular approach is composition into mutually aligned blocks and centered ones. The text should be readable, so it is better to keep the font size of the main text at minimum of 8 pts. But to stand out and emphasize the brand name, bigger font sizes are welcome.

4.1.2 Letterhead paper

Nowadays, one of the most critical corporate documents is letterhead papers because these are used in everyday company life. It supports a professional impression during business correspondence and is a crucial part of the company's first impression. Well-crafted corporate documents show and validate unified corporate design and branding.

Letterhead papers are used in communication with authorities and institutions, which can be an offer, order confirmation or an invoice for goods or services. (Mediagrafik, 2021)

This type of document includes the complete brand name, business name, company address, postal address if needed, company registration number, and VAT number. However, many of these paper standards aren't used anymore and the only thing that companies actually print on the paper is their logo.

The standard format for this print is A4 (210 x 297 mm), exceptionally it is possible to meet two-thirds or one-third size. (Horný, 2016)

4.2 Advertising and promotion

The main purpose of advertising is to convey information about the product to customers. Creative, consistent, and at the same time, unusual advertisements attract people's attention and increase the loyalty of the audience. A very popular option used to be outdoor advertising which is any advertising message placed outdoors on temporary or stationary objects but nowadays, digital advertisement taking the crown as its popularity is rising at a fast phase. Advertising prints can include basic newspaper advertisements, leaflets, banners, posters and catalogs.

4.2.1 Newspaper advertisement

Newspaper advertisements have been around for a long time as a traditional way for businesses to promote themselves or particular products or services. This type of advertising is always a part of another printed product, such as a journal, newspaper or a catalogue. The size of a newspaper advertisement is always relative to the page size of the carrier where it's printed, it can take the area of 1/16 of the page up to the full size of the page. (Horný, 2016)

4.2.2 Promotional banner

A designed promotional banner is an excellent option to declare the company's existence to the world and advertise its products or services. Banners can be printed or digital. Printed banners are located both outside and inside and be manufactured from various materials, such as vinyl, fabric, mesh, and paper – however, material depends on where the banner is located, which size it has, and what design or pictures are depicted on it.

In the digital era, people face banners in every social network and website they visit, even while checking the news or the weather forecast. Advertising web banners are divided into static, flash, and animated. Static banners are the most common since their production is not as expensive as in the case of animated ones. This type of banner does not annoy people that much and quickly gets to the main point. The most common banner sizes are 200 x 200, 250 x 250, 300 x 250, 160 x 600, 468 x 60, 728 x 90 and 300 x 50. The banner itself includes mainly the company name, logo, slogan, image, contact. These banners should not be overloaded with text, since the reader won't waste his time reading a wall of text. On the contrary, it is necessary to attract a potential client or buyer in a very short time. (Outbrain, 2023)

4.2.3 Catalogue

A promotional catalogue is another type of advertising print material with the main duty to document and promote services or products in a visually appealing and informative way. A catalog can be in both printed and online form and come in different formats such as brochures, A4, A5, square and longitudinal sizes. The difference between a catalogue and other promotional prints is that a catalogue includes all or most of the products or services which the company offers with detailed descriptions and prices. (Zale, 2021)

4.2.4 Promotional merchandise

Promotional items are customized products that firms can personalize accordingly to their brand and offer to customers in order to promote their brand and products. It has become a widely spread tool that can substantially help enhance brand awareness and familiarity among customers or potential customers. The type of items depends on the company's industry and its customer base. According to PPAI the most favored items are outwear, t-shirts, stationery, drinkware, power banks and USB drives. (Ama, 2021) All in all, free branded items evoke pleasure in people and show company's care and overall position towards customers.

4.3 Packaging

Today, more and more companies in various industries are devoting their efforts to make a good looking graphic design for their packaging. The reason for it is its rapid development and use as a crucial marketing tool.

Packaging became an important factor in mediating the relationship between the manufacturer, vendor and consumer. Essentially printed packaging represents the product on the market, which affects the quality of goods. Packaging is the kind of visual communication that influences the whole population and their feelings. In real life packaging makes it easier to do the shopping and orientate in the store when making repetitive buys. (Horný, 2016)

The final version of the package must comply with the basic principles:

- Reliability – the package must be high-quality enough to hold out transportation, storage in the shop and at the buyer's home. Moreover, the characteristics of the product and climatic conditions of storage places should be taken in consideration.
- Convenience – perfect scenario is when the package is either usable even after the goods run out or it is recyclable.
- Budget-wise – the material choice seems to be easy, but in fact, it is a utopia. While searching for the best fit by quality and type of the material, it is important to keep in mind that packaging with all costs of its production cannot cost more than the item inside of it.
- Visual appeal – the product's appearance should evoke positive emotions, make it memorable for the customer and also cause the customer's desire to buy it. During the development process, the color, shape, graphics, and used fonts should be considered.
- Informative – package must contain all necessary information about the contents, such as the product name, model, serial number, composition, expiration date, manufacturer's information, and method of use. (Packhelp, 2021)

5 Summary of the theoretical part

Within the theoretical part we have defined concepts of the brand itself, branding as a process with its elements. The second chapter was dedicated to corporate identity and its impact on the company's presentation to the world. It also included the description of corporate design, culture, communications, product and how these constituent parts are connected and have mutual influence. In the framework of essentials of corporate design, the importance of a logo, consistent visual style, and derived elements of corporate design were specified.

Practical part

6 Introduction to the practical part

The practical part of the thesis is devoted to the analysis of the company, and the development of a corporate design for it, which considerably improves the businesses representation on the market and communication with clients. Competition and market identification are also carried out. The most emphasis is placed on the analysis and development of corporate design. During the process, the logo will be changed, the color palette will be supplemented, and suitable typefaces will be selected. Subsequently, all of the above elements will be applied in practice on the corporate identity, and menu will be developed. The result of all steps above is case study or presentation of corporate design elements and its functionality in practice, which works as a union of all the elements mentioned.

7 Preparation and analysis of the company

In this chapter, I will compose the questions for the brief, and conduct it to collect all the information I need about the client's company, which I will then use as the base to create the corporate design. I will also analyze the competition and target audience.

7.1 Executing a brief

Every project begins with a set of tasks, deadlines and key points from the client side. That is why in the beginning a brief is prepared and conducted with the client. Brief is a document that contains an overview of the entire project. It helps the designer in maintaining a consistent look and works as a guidebook throughout the development of the visual identity of the firm. Before running a brief between the client and the designer it is crucial to write down all the necessary questions because the answers to them will help understand the main project goals, determine deadlines, company's vision, audience, competitors and required outcomes eg. what exactly they want to improve in their visual identity or redesign. The brief can be conducted in several ways – meeting in person, online meeting or answering the question through a form, which would be sent to the client. The most effective approach is to meet with the client. A designer's brief has its standards, but at times these standards might not match the company's needs therefore some adjustments are needed depending on the industry in which it is in. During the creation of the visual identity of the café, I developed a brief which consisted of questions and the answers, that I got from the client:

1. *Who is the client?*
Coffee place named Spokiy.
2. *Contact information and location*
Location: Sobornyi Ave, 159, Zaporizhzhia, Zaporizhian region, Ukraine.
Email address: owl.coffeebar@gmail.com
Contact number: +380 66 445 0908
3. *Activity profile*
Coffee place and takeaway coffee
4. *Main idea of the brand*
Providing quality services-coffee and desserts at a good price, a comfortable place to sit or just visit for a takeaway coffee.
5. *Goals of the brand*
Create a regular customer base. Gradually expand the menu, creating seasonal drinks.
6. *Project*
Completion of the visual identity.
7. *Aim of the project*
In the business environment of coffee places and shops the competition is high. So it is crucial not only to offer the best quality products and customers treatment, but

also have unified visual identity, that will help to stand out from the competition, attract more loyal customers and ensure consistent communication with them.

8. *Requirements from the client*

- Logo
- Color palette
- Fonts
- Brand pattern
- Examples of the derived elements use

9. *Naming*

Name should not be changed.

10. *Should slogan be added?*

No

11. *How new logo should look like*

Logo must consist of a graphic element and text – combination mark. It should be attractive, but not too overwhelming.

12. *Mandatory colors*

The client requests to keep pink as the primary color, but it would be advisable to expand the palette with additional colors.

13. *The creation of custom font*

No, the creation of custom font is not required.

14. *Desired emotional perception of the brand*

Calmness, sense of security, peace of mind in other words a safe place

7.2 Introduction to the company

Spokiy is a cafe opened in the summer of 2022, offering various coffee drinks and desserts. It is important to point out that Spokiy is a small individual cafe, not a franchise. It is located in the central part of Zaporizhzhia, a industrial city in the south-east of Ukraine.

It is owned by Bogdan Kiryanov, who also has a few more coffee spots – Owl coffee and Kava v artsi. Bogdan Kiryanov is a barista, whose passion is coffee and coffeemaking. In 2018 he opened his first coffee point. Its name was Owl coffee, and it worked only as a takeaway. In december 2021 he got an opportunity to open a café. He already had some experience in this business so he decided to go for it. Regrettably, Spokiy wasn't opened in time and the opening date had to be postponed due to the invasion on the territory of Ukraine. As the bigger part of the Zaporozhzhia region was taken (Zaporizhzhia is a city located 25 km away from the front line) a lot of residents left the town and the entrepreneurs were doubting whether it is wise to continue their activities or even open new places.

In the end Spokiy café was opened in June 2022. The owner of the café decided not to leave the city. He preferred stay and support the local economy and bring joy to people in these difficult times. Spokiy is also actively helping refugees - there is a special locker, where people who want to help can leave anything that might come in handy. On weekdays the coffee place is open from 9 am to 19 pm, on weekends from 11 am to 20 pm. The coffee place

belongs to the low-price segment, but the quality of offered products like coffee and desserts correspond to the medium-high level.

7.3 Competitive analysis

Before creating the design for the corporate style of the cafe, it is necessary to perform an analysis of the competition, which will provide an understanding of the current situation and give insight into the market category, in which the company operates. Finding this information serves as inspiration to create a more appropriate and unique corporate style, it also helps to avoid mistakes made by the competitors. Thus, as a part of analysis I conducted a research of cafes located in Zaporozhye, near Spokiy café. A lot of modern enterprises, who are interested in representing their business and communicating with customers through various channels have appeared over the past few years on the Ukrainian market as a whole, and as well as in Zaporozhye, currently the market is relatively saturated.

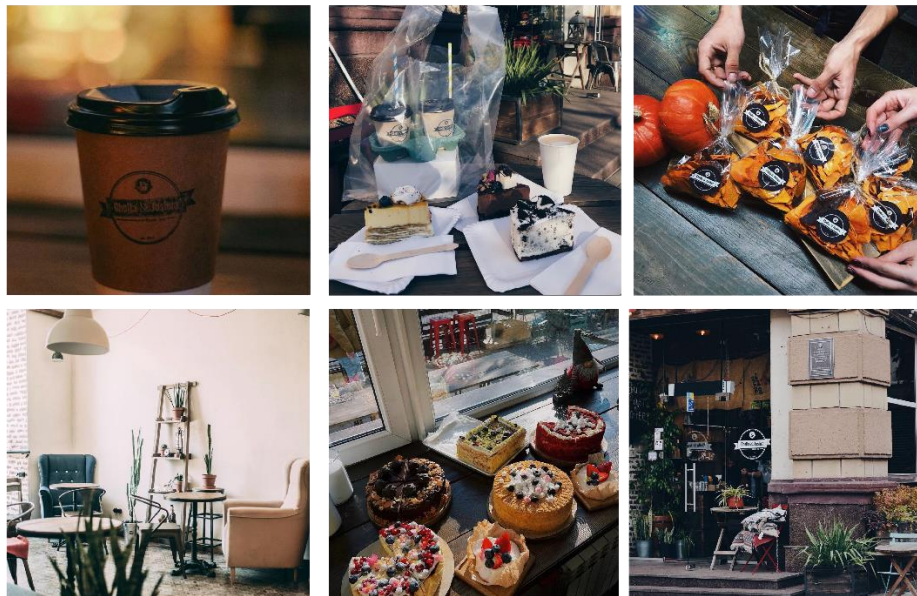
When conducting the competitor's analysis, first of all it is important to take into account the competition, which consists of both direct and indirect competitors. Direct competitors are active in the same market, and they offer similar products and services. Indirect competitors deliver different products, but still have the potential power to meet the general needs of our customers. As the direct competition, I consider single cafes and chain cafes; in the case of indirect competition - restaurants, bars and shopping centers.

7.3.1 Single coffee places

1. Cholla & Joshua

This coffee shop is located across the street from the cafe for which I am developing the corporate identity. It is a cozy place that belongs to the high price segment and was opened back in 2016. Throughout its existence, it has gained many regular customers, who rate it at 4.6 stars. Over time the business manager added breakfasts to the menu. The coffee shop had a corporate identity from the beginning and kept the corporate style consistent during all these years which helped them to achieve major success. In the Cholla & Joshua the corporate design creators did not use bright colors or unusual font typefaces, but quite the opposite. They used muted warm and cozy colors that perfectly complemented their logo. Moreover, they supported it with the help of communication channels and good Instagram management.

Figure 17: Cholla & Joshua



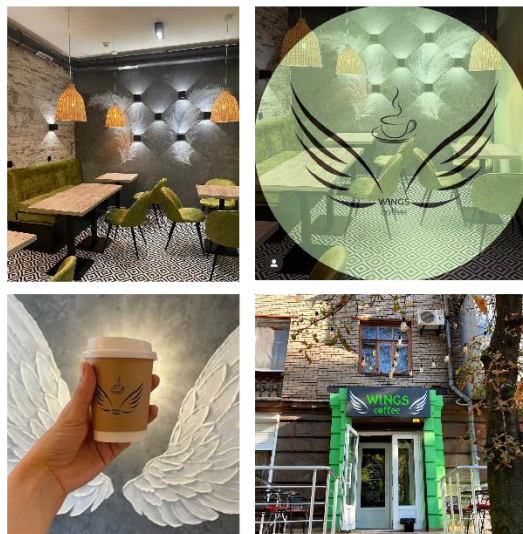
(own processing according to Cholla & Joshua instagram page)

2. Wings coffee

This coffee place is located in the same district as Spokiy café. It is a relatively new café, and it belongs to the medium price segment. They opened up at the end of summer 2021. In this café people can order not only coffee, but also desserts, macarons and a breakfast, which is served throughout the day.

Wings coffee is not a very popular place compared to its competitors, but nevertheless has enough regular customers. However, it is important to note that the target audience is different from the one of Cholla & Joshua or Coffeelab Roasters. Families with children and middle-aged people often come here for a coffee during the week or for the breakfast on the weekend. Wings coffee has a rating of 4.6 stars, but only 11 people rated the place, which is a fairly small number. This café has a combined logo, which depicts wings, and a coffee mug above the wings. This could very well work together but not here. The execution of the design isn't good, the elements stand out on their own rather than match. In their corporate style, they used green, gray, and cream colors. The interior is made in a similar style. It is crucial to point out, that using this shade of green with such a symbol in the logo was a successful decision but the signboard with the logo at the entrance to the coffee place is way more saturated than it is on their Instagram profile.

Figure 18: Wings coffee



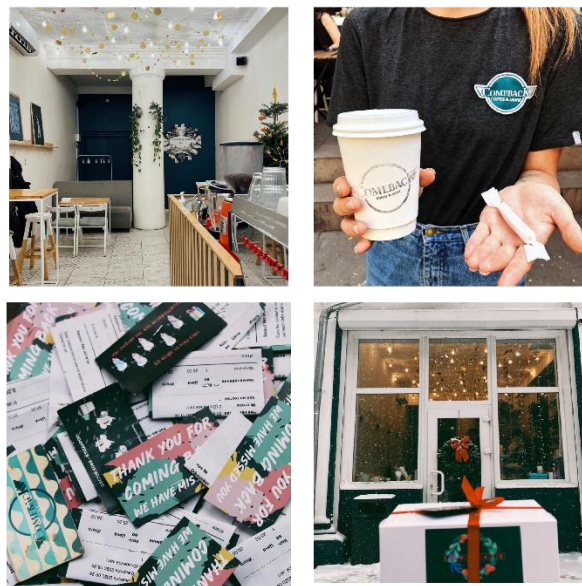
(own processing according to Wings coffee instagram page)

3. Comeback coffee

Small coffee place with a huge outside seating, located 2 km away from Spokiy café. This is a very young café and space for creative people which is famous for its sandwiches of 5 different types and popcorn latte. They opened in 2016 and at that time, they were innovators because they served unusual types of lattes and put out creative content on their Instagram. People often come here to meet with the friends or just to enjoy the morning coffee while sitting outside. This café is pet-friendly, offers books and magazine to read while sitting and offers a unique opportunity to buy paintings and postcards created by local artists. They also offer some benefits to their customers - every sixth coffee is for free. The employees are very friendly and the atmosphere in Comeback coffee is always very cosy and warm.

Despite its simplicity, the logo and corporate style of the café is memorable. They use their corporate colours in the interior, visual style of Instagram and packaging of their products - kombucha, cakes, coffee cups and merchandise like clothing for staff, coffee mugs and dishes in the café.

Figure 19: Comeback coffee



(own processing according to Comeback coffee instagram page)

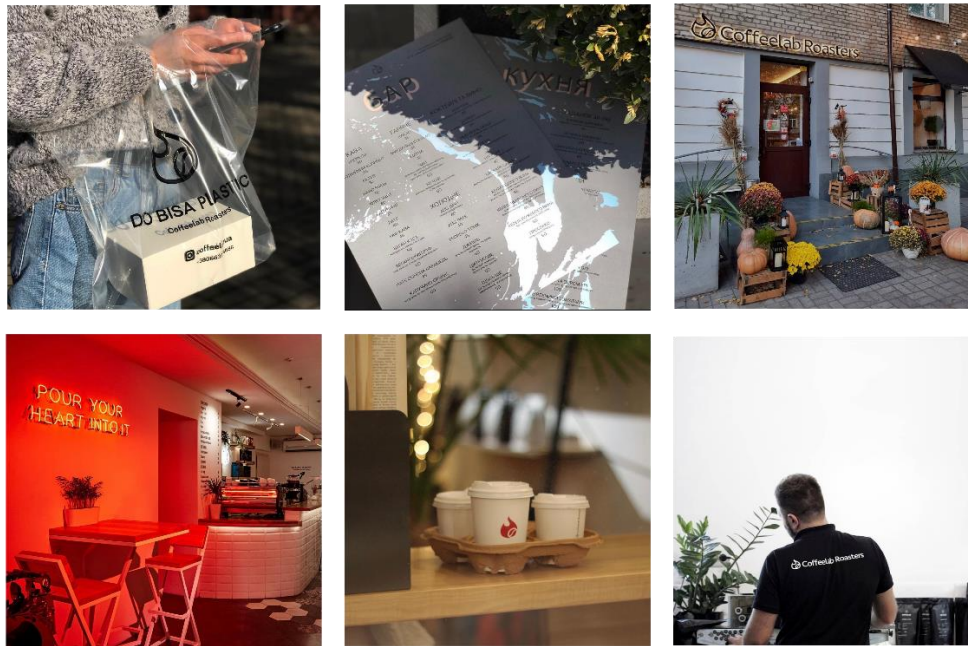
7.3.2 Chain coffee places

1. Coffeelab Roasters

Coffeelab roasters is a chain of coffee shops, one of their branches is located within the walking distance of the Spokiy cafe. What they do is pretty clear from their name and logo, besides making coffee and desserts, they roast coffee beans and, afterwards use them in their coffee points or sell them to other coffee places in Zaporizhzhia and all over Ukraine. The creators of this café chain build a culture out of Coffeelab roasters cafes, as they host various workshops and classes with experts from different fields for their customers.

This chain of cafes belongs to the medium price segment. Their branch near Spokiy catches the person's eye with the icon, which is a part of their combined logo and subsequently with its interior. The corporate design is made in a minimalist style, but at the same time there are also bright accents which makes a winning combination with graphic symbols or icons. Coffeelab roasters cafe often makes seasonal dishes and drinks and refreshes the menu design with it. The coffee shop's corporate identity is used on such media carriers as business cards, advertisement banners, menu, coffee cups for takeaway, carrier bags and food boxes, coffee packaging and Instagram visual style. It is worth noting that this café chain is a strong competitor.

Figure 20: Coffeelab Roasters



(own processing according to Coffeelab Roasters instagram page)

2. Lviv Handmade Chocolate

Lviv Handmade Chocolate – is a chocolate workshop, that was founded in Lviv in 2008. It is a place where the owners want to preserve the ancient traditions of Lviv chocolate manufacturing. Lviv handmade chocolate offers various kinds of chocolates – chocolate, desserts, more than 60 types of nuts dipped in chocolate and cream candies. The idea is to produce chocolates from high-quality raw materials available in Lviv, and to work with the best production specialists to keep the product handmade.

The corporate design of this company is quite consistent, it is a strong brand. Coming to this place, a customer feels as if he had fallen into a fairy tale, and it was real. In all the cities where this cafe is located, a piece of Lviv lives, since this brand is directly connected with this city with a rich history. Out of all their branches the Lviv one is the most popular one. This situation happens quite often when it comes to such brands, as people usually prefer the local, albeit smaller brands, since their philosophy and history is closer to them.

Figure 21: Lviv Handmade Chocolate



(own processing according to Lviv Handmade Chocolateinstagram page)

7.4 Identification of the target audience

One of the main stages of designing the corporate identity of a coffee place or its products is an analysis of the target audience. Target audience or target group is a group of people characterized by specific demographic data, behavior and features, basically the ideal customers that owners aim to attract to the café. By understanding ideal customer's needs, lifestyle, owners can create products, design and customized menu to match their requests and tastes. So before creating a corporate design, I need to accurately capture the interests of the people they are trying to target, like their desires, needs and lifestyle.

7.4.1 Segmentation

What I firstly do is a segmentation using the “5W” method of Mark Sherrington to correctly determine the target audience. During the process I ask 5 questions:

- What? – determines the product type by particular properties: what exactly does a café offer to its customers?
- Who? – the type of consumer according to various characteristics: gender, age, marital status, education, job and income level.
- Why? – by what the customer is guided when purchasing a product, what problem does it solve?
- When? – at what time (time of the day, holidays) was the product purchased?
- Where? – at which place does the purchase exactly happened?

Based on the statement of the owner of the café, I made three main segments of customers for the Spokiy café in Zaporizhzhia city. I visualized them in the format of the tables below.

Table 1: Analysis of the first segment of the target audience

First segment of the target audience	
What?	Buy coffee on the way to work
Who?	Office workers or vendors at the age 21 – 50 years
Why?	To feel more cheerful in the morning, it is as a morning ritual or habit
When?	In the morning of a workday, it doesn't depend on the season of the year
Where?	In the café, that is located not far from the office buildings or shops, where people work.

Table 2: Analysis of the first segment of the target audience

Second segment of the target audience	
What?	Come to café to work or come after classes to do school tasks in a café with a cup of coffee and a dessert
Who?	Freelancers, people who work remotly, students

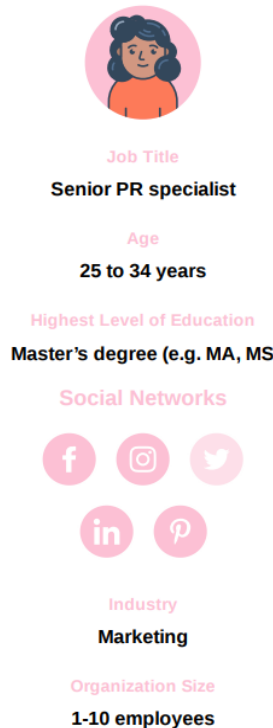
Why?	To avoid usual everyday life, change of scenery, work in the enjoyable and motivational place
When?	During the day, in autumn, winter or spring
Where?	In the coffee place, that is not far from universities or their homes

Table 3: Analysis of the first segment of the target audience

Third segment of the target audience	
What?	Visit the coffee place and buy coffee to enjoy meeting with friends, family or personal time
Who?	People at the age of 16-35 years, couples, friends
Why?	Café is an ideal place to meet, here people can get aesthetic pleasure and drink quality coffee
When?	It doesn't depend on the season of the year, it can be on the weekends, on the afternoons of the any day
Where?	In the coffee place, that looks cozy with a good offer of coffee drinks and food

7.4.2 Persona creation based on segmentation

Figure 22: Persona 1



After finishing the segmentation of the target audience, I continued with the analysis of a person technique. A person implies a "collective image" of the target client, one micro-segment embodied in the image of a particular person. As part of this, I created three customer portraits or personas, each from a different segment.

1) The first persona is Elena Kravec, she belongs to the first segment of the target audience of Spokiy café.

Elena Kravec is an active and open-minded girl from Zaporizhzhia, who is working in a young marketing firm as a Senior PR specialist, full-time. The office of the company is located in the city center. She is quite versatile, loves to learn new things in the field of her work and often attends workshops. In her free time, she likes to meet with her friends, go to cozy coffee places, and enjoys photography. Before work she likes to drop by a coffee shop and take a cup of latte with her. To some extent, it makes her day and mood better, as she really appreciates the quality of the coffee in the café. Coffee from a café always seems tastier and more fragrant to her, and she wants to feel cheerful from the beginning of the day.

(own processing according to HubSpot, ©2023)

Figure 23: Persona 2



2) The second persona is Marianna Meshkova, she belongs to the third segment of the target audience of Spokiy cafe.

Marianna Meshkova is a young girl at the age of 18. Currently she is in her first year of Bachelor studies in Zaporizhzhia State Medical University. Most of her time she spends studying. For now, she is unemployed, therefore Marianna is financially supported by her parents.

She likes to read. She's in a relationship with an older boy from the same university. Besides, she has a few friends, with whom she likes to go for a coffee and dessert in modern and attractively designed cafés.

(own processing according to HubSpot, ©2023)

Figure 24: Persona 3



Job Title

UI/UX Designer

Age

18 to 24 years

Highest Level of Education

Master's degree (e.g. MA, MS)

Social Networks



Industry

IT

Organization Size

1-10 employees

3) Alexey Kozakov is the third persona, who represents the second segment of the target audience of Spokiy cafe.

Alexey Kozakov is a young man of 24 years old, who completed his university studies a year ago. He used to go to one of the state universities of Zaporozhye. Now he works in a software company as a UX/UI Designer. Alexey is open to new experiences and up for new acquaintances. He's in a relationship, his girlfriend also works in the design industry. On his own or with his girlfriend, he often goes to work in cafes on days when he can work remotely. He feels like the environment there is way more inspiring and motivating for him, and coffee gives him energy.

(own processing according to HubSpot, ©2023)

In conclusion this chapter provided a full analysis of the company, in my case café Spokiy, for which I was developing a united corporate design. At the beginning, I wrote down the brief questions, which I afterwards discussed with the client and got answers for them.

I also conducted the design prototype analysis of corporate identities of coffee shops near Spokiy café, such as Cholla & Joshua, Wings coffee and Comeback coffee and I highlighted features and advantages of their corporate design.

After that I analyzed the target audience – firstly I did it with the help of segmentation using “5W” method and then using the persona segmentation, which resulted in the creation of three personas according to the three segments of the target audience.

8 Draft of the unified visual style for Spokiy cafe

All corporate design ideas for Spokiy café are going to be created on the basis of the information and data obtained during the analysis of the company, its target audience, and competitors. In addition, substantial contribution was made with the help of regular communication and feedback received from the customer who was the owner of Spokiy in my case.

I am going to put a big emphasis on the formation of unique constants of cafe corporate design, in order for them to fully reflect the company, its philosophy, values and, consequently, ensure the practical applicability of these elements and an increase in brand awareness.

Taking into account all the needs and requirements of the company operating in this industry, I will develop three basic elements of corporate design – corporate colors, logo and font. The creation of a mascot was omitted and there was no need to come up with a new name for the cafe.

8.1 Naming

As it was already mentioned in the theoretical part the name should be easy to say and be memorable. Name should help a new product, in my case the café and its offerings, to stand out from the competition and ensure a creation of its own niche in the market. Human consciousness is made in such a way that the unique, creative, sensual that stands out from the general mass is best remembered. To ensure that all these aspects are accounted for and fulfilled. The names used by the competitors should also be evaluated.

In the case of a café, for which I projected the corporate design, the name was already set, and the owner insisted to keep it and have all subsequent elements of design based on it. The name of the café consisted of two words - Spokiy coffee.

The name is written in Latin letters, but the word itself is of Ukrainian origin. The first part of the name, word *spokiy* (*cnokiï*) in Ukrainian means *calm*. The owner of the coffee place, Bogdan Kiryanov, chose this name for a several reasons. The biggest role of this decision played the fact that the café opened after the beginning of the full-scale invasion to Ukraine, precisely in the summer of 2022, as I stated in the chapter before. People from a city that is located close to the front line, live in a constant fear and apprehension. Do not know what will happen next and are overwhelmed with bad news. All they and the rest of the world wants is peace, tranquility, and harmony in their life. From the start of the military conflict people began to appreciate peace and silence in a different way, more than ever and from that the café name originates. Spokiy should be thought of as an island of tranquility, not only during war time, but even in an ordinary busy week at work, or examination period at

university. All in all, this name is well remembered and it sounds good, so it is a good choice of name for such café.

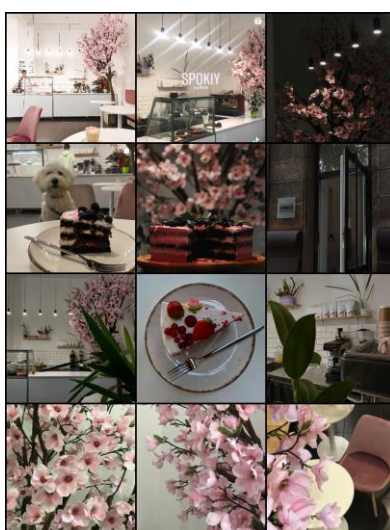
The second part of the name, *coffee*, helps customers understand what the company does and what it can offer them. It is important to mention that the enterprise is operated in the Ukrainian language and is aimed towards Ukrainian citizens. The first part of the word is a factual Ukrainian word written in Latin letters, so there should not be any difficulties with it. The second part of the name of the cafe is written in English but is a common word familiar to everyone. As part of the creation of the visual style, the uniqueness of the name was also checked. After the check, it was confirmed that no other company operates under this name in Ukraine, which allows the use of this name and even a trademark.

8.2 Current visual style of the café

Initially everything in this café brand identity wise was created by the owner and his wife, which is why, in fact, the entire visual style consisted only of the name in Sans serif font on a pink background. The pink color, as I have already mentioned, was chosen because of the interior in which the Sakura tree is. Communication with customers is done via Instagram but not on regular basis and they do not use any graphic elements that would identify their brand and increase brand awareness.

During the development of the unified visual style, in addition to the design constants, drafts for takeaway paper coffee cups, loyalty card for regular visitors, a business card with the contact on the owner and a uniform for baristas will be created. Moreover, a printed menu in paper form does not exist yet, there is only a written list of coffee drinks on the wall behind the bar. The same goes for the desserts, which only have a price tag placed right next to them in the showcase. That is why a concept for the menu will also be created.

Figure 25: Visual style



(own processing according to Spokiy coffee instagram page)

8.3 Moodboard

Doing a moodboard is not obligatory, but I always prefer to use this method in creating a visual style. Before starting I make sketches and first drafts. It really helps me to understand the client's "mood" for the project. Moodboard can include a set of images, logos, patterns, fonts, and color combinations. Some designers include all these elements or few of them into one moodboard, some create separate moodboards for logo, illustrations, and patterns. It is made in order to understand what the visual solution will be: serious or easy going, light, elitist or democratic, which visuals will be taken as the basis, what color harmony will fit the project and what kind of typography will be used.

For my project of the café Spokiy I created only one moodboard, which included inspiration for the logo, graphic symbol, fonts; ordinary images also were added. When I was compiling the moodboard, I considered the fact, that the client wants to have a colorful logo, that can be made in illustrative way and should include a graphic symbol and text as well. The fonts should not be the simplest ones, but using very decorative fonts is also not the best option for the project of this café.

When choosing the proper references for this project, I was guided by several things: the color combination and the contrast of colors overall, then the choice of logos, what effect and emotion the logo gives with those or other colors in the same field of businesses, and the third the visual style as a whole.

Figure 26: Moodboard



(own processing)

8.4 Color palette

During the communication with the client during the brief, the client confirmed that the color palette of the corporate identity can be expanded, but pink color must remain as the primary color of the Spokiy café and should be primary color in the logo as well. The reason for this is visible in the interior of the coffee place. Plates, mugs, lighting, furniture and even blankets for outdoor seating are color matching.

Figure 27: Spokiy coffee interior and bar



(own processing according to Spokiy coffee instagram page)

Pink color is usually associated with femininity and girls, it is even often called "girly". Thus, this color in the classical connotation takes many of the qualities traditionally attributed to women: sensitivity and care.

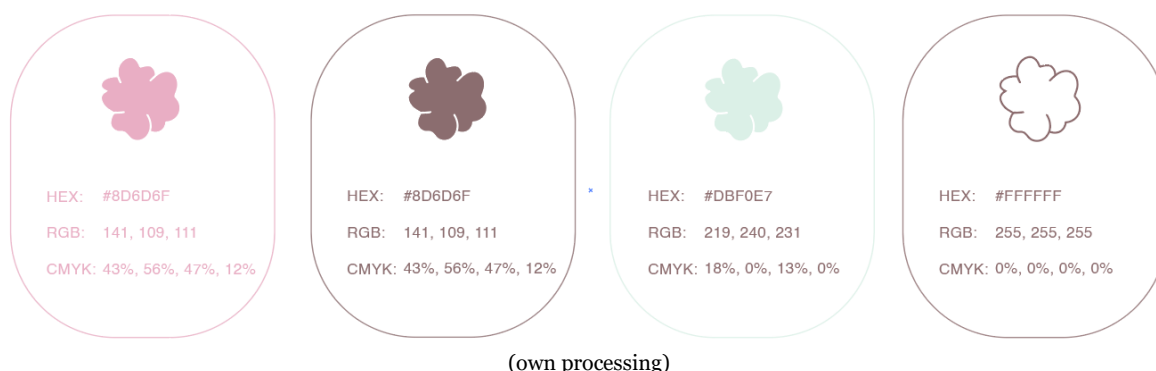
However, in this case, the owner of the coffee place Spokiy had different reason and connotation, for which he subsequently used pink and a large cherry tree near the coffee bar. It is connected to Japanese culture, where this color is more closely related to the cherry trees with pink blooming flowers, which symbolize the beginning of life. Thus, the use of such a light pink color in this case refers to calmness, hope, strength, warmth, and harmony.

For my development the corporate colors were defined in different models, the most decisive were the RGB and CMYK models, I also added codes of colours in HEX for convenience, as it is often used in HTML and other programming languages. RGB is a digital color model used to create colors on the screen or when displaying digital images. This model is based on a combination of red, green and blue colors in various proportions to create millions of shades of color. Each pixel on the screen consists of a combination of these three primary colors, which can be adjusted in different brightness levels, in the range from 0 to 255, where a color with a value of 0 has the lowest intensity and with a value of 255 has the highest. Applying the RGB scheme to create printed layouts can negatively affect the color reproduction in the finished product due to the different nature of the color. The CMYK color space is subtractive because it is built on light absorption unlike RGB. If in CMYK color model all color components will be added up, the final color will be black.

Conventional painting works on the same principle, and therefore CMYK color model is used in printing. Through percentages, the proportions of four colors are recorded in it: Cyan, Magenta, Yellow and Key color, black. The intensity of each color is set as a percentage from 0 to 100. CMYK is used in the printing industry for printing photos and color illustrations and small print runs as well as in home and office printers. All graphic outputs and drafts for Spokiy cafe will be done in RGB.

Based on the information about the color's meanings, perception, and idea behind the café a palette of corporate colors was developed to create the corporate identity of the Spokiy coffee place:

Figure 28: Color palette



Pink remained as the primary color on the request of the client. I expanded the color palette with secondary colors: light brown, light turquoise and white. I added brown, because it symbolizes coffee, then turquoise as it is a suitable match here, because such shade of green and blue is associated with peace and tranquility which helps to harmonize the pink color in this corporate identity. It also makes perfect contrast with the pink color. White color gives comfort and lightness.

8.5 Fonts choice

An important part of corporate identity is the corporate fonts, which are used in the appearance of textual content. Fonts should as well as other elements match the idea and style of the designed project, emphasize the features of the brand image and meet the specifics of the company's activities. Selection of the appropriate fonts was a highly challenging and time-consuming task.

All in all, during this phase I selected two fonts. Firstly, I wanted to use a script font for a logo, but the main idea, attention and emphasis of the logo was placed on the graphic symbol, so I had to accept the fact, that the graphic symbol in combination with a detailed or too decorative font will not look good. The aim was to make the logo of Spokiy café look timeless, welcoming within the possible limits. That is why I chose Americana Bold font as the main font, for the logo. Americana is a serif typeface, that combines simplicity and at the same time modernity, lightness and elegance. Subsequently, I chose a second font, rather a typeface Helvetica, that has a wide range of sans serif fonts, that replenishes the first font and is usable both for shorter and longer texts. In the primary logo I used Helvetica

Light and for the texts and secondary logo both Helvetica Regular and Helvetica Light. It is important to mention that those fonts are free only for personal use, but if the client would really want to use it in real life, he must purchase a license for a commercial use from a reputable typeface foundry like Adobe or Monotype.

Figure 29: Font selection

Americana Bold

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ
abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz123456789

Helvetica Regular

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ
abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz123456789

Helvetica Light

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ
abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz123456789

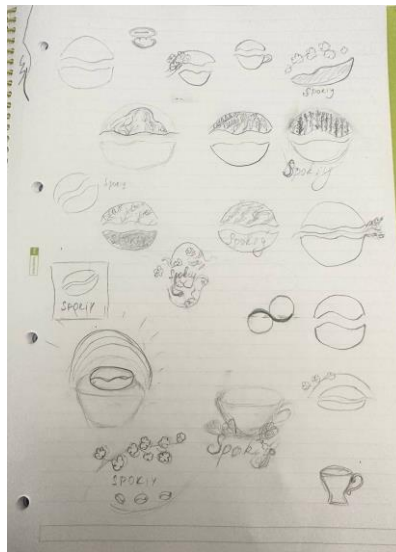
(own processing)

8.6 Logo creation

The process of creating various logo designs was based on the café name Spokiy, which means calm; corporate colors and interior constituent of the café. Therefore, the main elements in creating a compositional solution were a blossoming sakura tree and a coffee bean. Since the client initially approved the idea of a logo with a graphic symbol, I started the designing process from creating a graphic symbol.

I began designing by sketching on paper, as it is way easier and gives more freedom than immediate idea creation in graphic editors on the computer. The process of designing continues afterwards in such editors, but using them in the first step, can limit and distract the graphic designer. Sketching on paper is also more natural and the designer is able to produce a lot of design ideas in a short time with just a pencil. The alternative option can be sketching on a graphic tablet. After I finished drawing, I continued with sorting the sketches and selecting the most suitable and relevant to the requirements discussed in the brief and the ones, that expressed the brand the most. Of those I selected a few and recreated them in the digital form with the help of Adobe Illustrator.

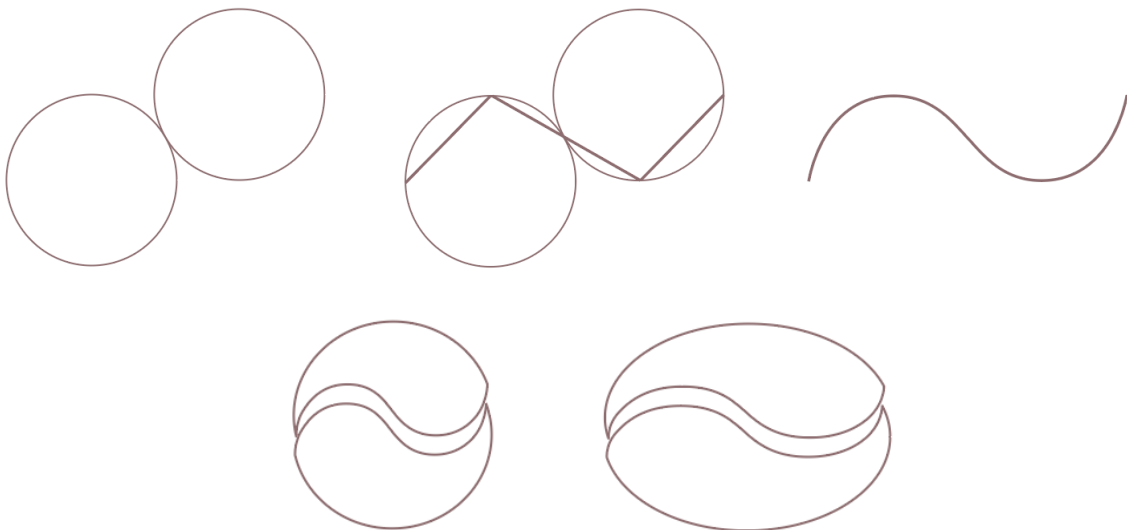
Figure 30: Logo sketches



(own processing)

The vector graphics program made it easy to play with details of the symbol and slightly adjust them, the same applies to the use of colors in the logo. A small change in the position of the symbol or some other smaller elements of the logo actually constitutes in a big change of the overall look. As was already mentioned the main idea was to use a coffee bean, divided in half, fill one part with the sakura blossom, since a blossoming sakura tree serves as an association for this brand and keep the second part looking like a regular coffee bean. The coffee bean was made up using simple geometric shapes firstly to create the key points and then drawn with a pen tool.

Figure 31: Vector logo creation



(own processing)

The element of the coffee bean helps in understanding to which industry the café belongs and the sakura blossom makes clear what the brand is about. It is a signature element of

this coffee place. The goal was to create a logo that attracts attention, but at the same time it is not that oversaturated, simple, timeless, and with enough “air” in it.

Figure 32: Logo options



(own processing)

I created 6 options of the logo and later eliminated those, that were not matching the Spokiy café as much as the others. After I selected the most appealing and appropriate primary logo, I also developed a secondary logo draft, that could be used, when the branding space is limited or when it does not fit the primary logo. Primary and secondary logos will mainly be used in corporate colors but are accessible and usable in a monochrome version too (black and white).

Figure 33: Primary and secondary logo



(own processing)

The primary and secondary logo design was completed by using different corporate color options. As was already mentioned the corporate color is one of the most important components of the corporate identity. Color makes the corporate identity elements look more attractive and more memorable, it also allows for a powerful emotional impact.

Figure 34: Corporate color options for primary and secondary logo



(own processing)

During this chapter, the development of corporate design elements was carried out. I began with the description and analysis of the current corporate design of the café. I analyzed the existing name: I described it and explained why such name works well associative and phonetic wise. Afterwards I created a moodboard by gathering suitable fonts, logos and color schemes to better understand the clients vision.

When choosing the brand colors I kept pink as the main color and extended the color palette with three more colors - turquoise color, which symbolizes peace, harmony and lightness; light brown, which symbolizes coffee, and white as the base color which symbolizes freedom and simplicity. I also found two matching fonts for the project. Combining these I created the concepts for the primary and secondary logo, using a graphic element and font

adjustments. Both primary and secondary logos correspond to the goals and objectives of the project.

9 Derived elements of corporate design for Spokiy café

In this chapter, I will use corporate design elements to create new derived ones for the cafés unified corporate style. I will design merchantile prints and corporate clothing because products in print will help increase the awareness of the coffee shop and also create a pattern to use for the wrapping paper.

9.1 Business and loyalty card

A business card is one of the most popular and important components of the corporate identity of any company. It complements the professional image of the owner in my case, and the company overall. The owner of the Spokiy café can use it while establishing business relationships or when someone has questions directly for the owner of the café. A business card for Spokiy café was developed in a way to be easily readable with information simply memorizable and to have a directly associated look with the café. That's why I put the most emphasis on the use of the logo, its main elements and readability of the text. On the front side of the business card the logo of the coffee shop is placed and on the back side the important information such as the name and surname of the owner, his contact information and Spokiy café adress.

Figure 35: Business card



(own processing)

The loyalty card design was developed with the purpose of encouraging the customers to come back. Its design is different from the design of the business card. On the front side main logo elements such as cherry blossom branch and coffee bean, and secondary logo are

placed and on the back side we can find empty spaces for stamps. Loyalty cards were made in four different color options.

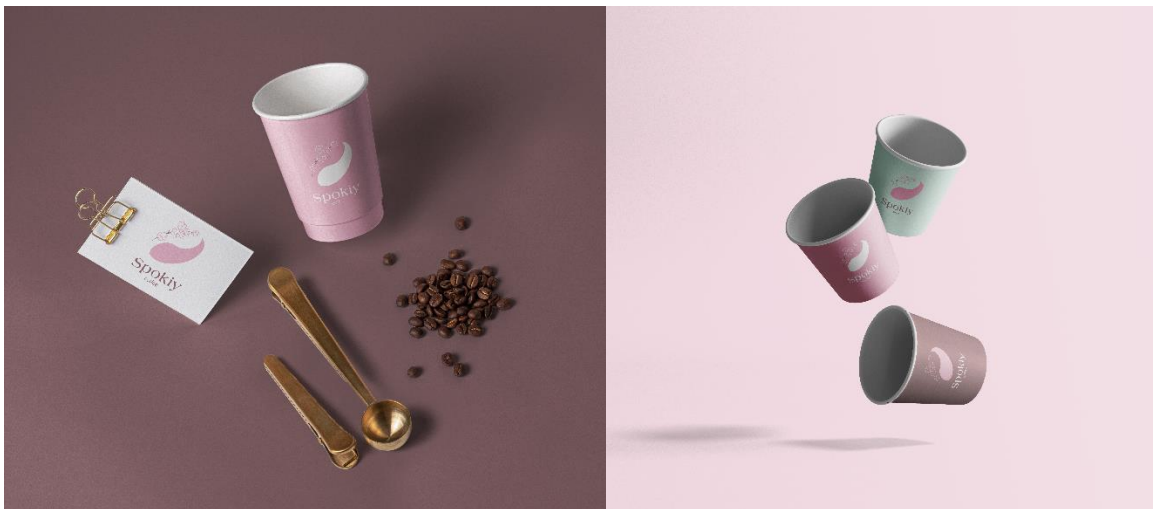
Figure 36: Loyalty card



(own processing)

9.2 Paper coffee cups

Figure 37: Paper coffee cups



(own processing)

Paper coffee cup is a commonly used thing in coffee shops, so there was a need to create a design for it as well. I decided to make it simple and not too overwhelming. There are 4 different colors of cups according to the corporate colors. The primary logo of the café developed in the previous chapter is placed on the coffee cup.

9.3 Wrapping paper

For the purpose of creating a design for the wrapping paper I created a pattern, which consisted of a coffee bean in pink color and a cherry blossom branch. Patterns usually help the brand to stand out from the competition even more, because pattern is a corporate design element created specially for your brand, it is not a replicable element.

Wrapping paper can be used for packaging, which is a solution of effective communication with target consumers, who have already come to the café and are ready to buy the product. The main task, while creating a concept for it is to attract customers attention and convince, that coming to this café was the right choice.

Figure 38: Wrapping paper

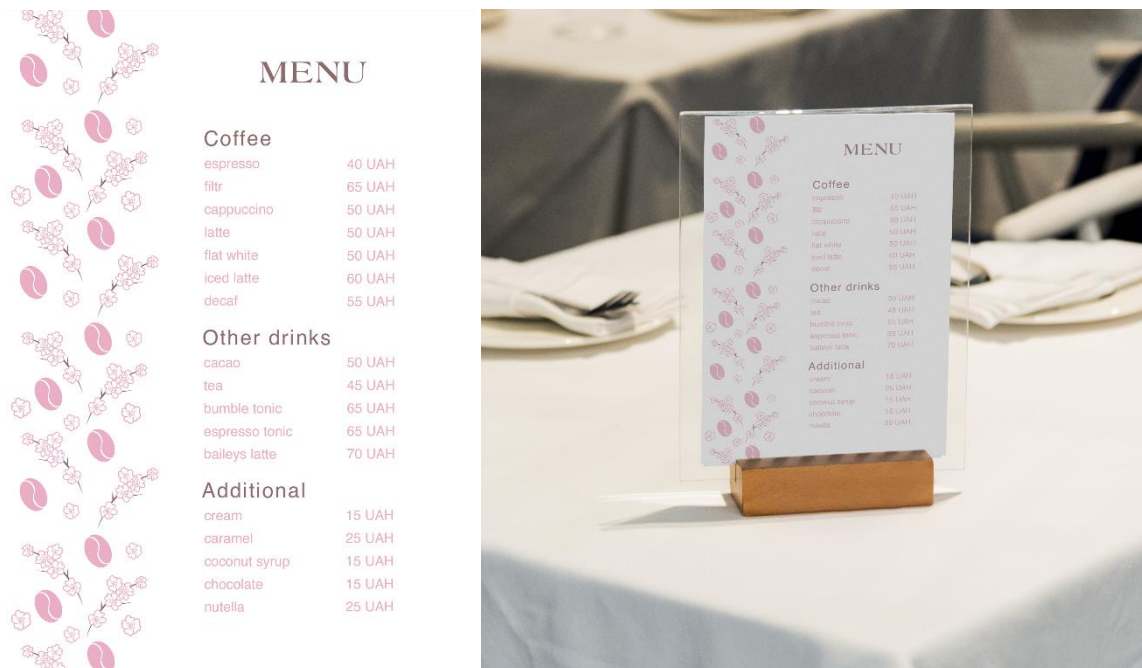


(own processing)

9.4 Menu

The decision to make a concept for the menu was made because there was no paper menu available in Spokiy café. Based on the requirements of the client, I created a menu which included only coffee drinks, tea and cocoa because the offer of cakes and desserts changes quite often. The size of the menu was set at 148 x 210 mm and to be one sided. In its design I also used the pattern, which I mentioned earlier in this chapter.

Figure 39: Menu



(own processing)

9.5 Café uniform

During the process of creating the derived elements of the corporate design, I also developed a concept of the uniform design for baristas in Spokiy café. Clothing, which baristas have themselves, also plays a crucial role. It happens often that baristas in casual clothing seem to be less trustworthy and professional. Otherwise, unified form also makes people working at the café easily identifiable to the customers. (MfAsia, 2021)

A concept design for a T-shirt and an apron was developed. They are similar to each other because the main logo of the Spokiy café is placed on the front side of them. The logo on the T-shirt is used in smaller size and the logo on the apron is way bigger. For the apron I chose the brown color from the corporate color palette, because other colors are too bright and since were in in the café business things can get messy and the darker color can help with that because stains are not so visible on it so its practical and for the T-shirt I chose a pink ringer tee with white color, as the base. Here the white is acceptable because the barista will be hidden in the apron so the white won't get messy.

Figure 40: Café uniform



(own processing)

In this chapter I created drafts for merchantile prints, corporate clothing, promotional merchandise and packaging paper. All these items were designed in accordance with the primary design concept and café's corporate identity. It contains: a business card, a loyalty card, coffee cups, uniform and wrapping paper.

10 Presentation of the project outputs

In this bachelor's thesis I mainly worked with branding, meaning I focused on its consecutive application on the visual elements of the café. Therefore, a presentation instead of a graphic manual will be processed for the purposes of this work. It will have a significant emphasis placed upon how to correctly use the created design elements for the branding of Spokiy café which is the main goal of this thesis.

However, a necessary part of this project is the presentation of outputs – corporate design elements and its application.

The following parts were added to the presentation:

- a brief introduction of the cafe and its target group;
- a moodboard of the project involving inspiration and mood in the form of images, logos, fonts and derived branding elements;
- the process of creating a logo and its main idea;
- primary and secondary logos;
- typography - the fonts chosen for the project;
- color palette;
- design elements used for branding.

High-quality and responsible processing of the presentation of the outputs of the work can significantly enhance the result in the eyes of the client. As for the processing of the graphic manual and consequently the real implementation of the elements in practice, will depend on the preferences of the client. The complete presentation is in the Attachment section below.

Conclusion

The main goal of this thesis was to develop a functional concept of a corporate design for the cafe. Based on this goal the bachelor thesis was divided into theoretical and practical parts. After that, each part was accordingly divided into five chapter. The theoretical part included knowledge, which I subsequently used in the creation of the companys corporate design in the practical part.

In the theoretical part I had a plan to start by defining the brand and gradually through the explanation to get to the structure of the corporate design, its primary and secondary elements. In the first chapter, I defined the concept of brand and branding. I also explained the relationship between brand identity and brand image. I also defined the corporate identity. While defining this term, I understood that different professionals often define it in different ways. It also depends in which language the definition is written. The second chapter was devoted to the elements of the corporate identity - corporate communications, corporate culture, corporate design and product. In the third chapter, I discussed one part of the corporate identity in more detail, namely corporate design. I went through the primary elements of corporate design, which were subsequently created in the practical part. The fourth chapter dealt with the description of the secondary elements of corporate design and what is its actual use in practice.

In the first chapter of the practical part, I came up with questions for an interview with the client so that I could get a fully defined assignment including clients requirements. After completing this part, the analysis of the enterprise, the analysis of the competitors and the target audience of the cafe began. After I had it done, the creation process began, in which I created a moodboard in the beginning to better understand the customer's vision. The name of the café was left at the request of the client. Exceptional features of this cafe were the use of pink as the primary color, which is not often a color used for a coffee shops corporate identity and the existence of a tree in the interior of the café. As part of the logo design, I created a primary and secondary logo.

In addition, I expanded the color palette by 3 colors and chose two suitable fonts. After creating the main elements, I applied them to different items and merchandise - coffee cups, uniform, business card, loyalty card and more. The last chapter was devoted to creating a presentation of corporate design for the cafe. This presentation included all the design elements and an illustration of their possible usecases.

I believe that my work was beneficial and successful because the client was pleased and liked what I did and said he was looking to apply some of my ideas to the business.

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Appendices

Appendix A: Presentation of the outputs



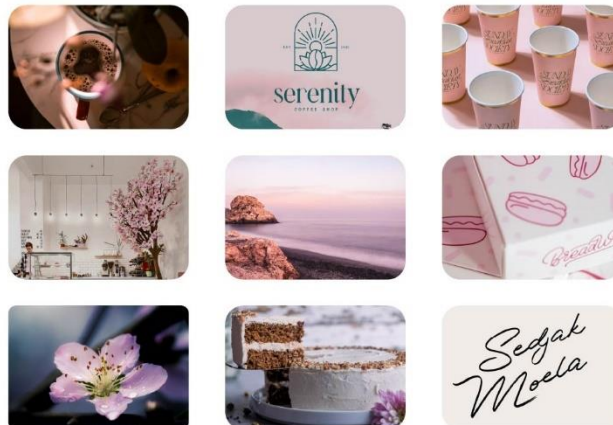
Spokiy

Spokiy coffee shop is a place, where everyone can find their island of tranquility in the bustling and hurrying world. All year round, there is a huge sakura tree in the cafe, which illuminates the space and gives a feeling of spring, lightness and calmness. Spokiy greets guests with hospitality, delicious desserts and coffee at any time of the year.

Its customers are people rushing to work in the morning, friends or couples walking around the city on their off day from work or school, freelancers and people working remotely, can come, work in the cafe and enjoy the atmosphere of comfort, tranquility and fragrant coffee.



Feel the emotions

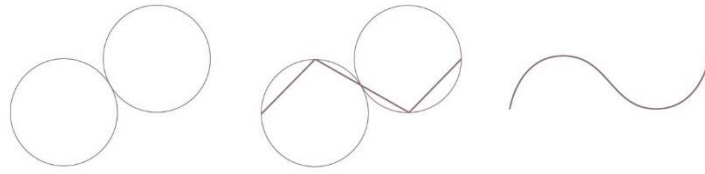




Typography



Form development



Logo concept









